



EFFECTIVE HUMANITARIAN LEADERSHIP IN SUDAN

**Beyond conventional paths, behaviours and
competencies**

Carine Jonckheere

"I declare that I, Carine Jonckheere, am the sole author of this assignment and the work is a result of my own investigations, except where otherwise stated.

All references have been duly cited"

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ABSTRACT

Today, radical changes are occurring in the humanitarian sector. The dominance of protracted and domestic conflict-based crises in Muslim-majority countries is creating an entirely new humanitarian landscape that infringes on standard relief assistance procedures. More so, it alters the very definition of the overall aim and boundaries of humanitarian aid (Hyder, 2007; Aly, 2014).

Whilst this new humanitarian landscape is extensively studied, the analysis of its impact on humanitarian leadership fails to appear in the related research. Similarly, the numerous enquiries that seek to uncover an effective humanitarian leadership model scarcely integrate this new contextual reality (Angus & McNicoll, 2012; Buchanan-Smith & Scriven, 2011). To date, the bridge between the new humanitarian frame and the core leadership competencies required to face it has not been built.

This research therefore seeks to uncover the leadership competencies and skills required to lead an effective relief intervention in Sudan, defined as one of the most prolonged and complex domestic crises of the 21st century to date (Buston & Smith, 2014). The research is built on two distinctive propositions. The first proposition outlines the situational strength of Sudan, establishing the level of influence this context has on leadership mechanisms and behaviours. The second proposition analyses the efficient leadership behaviours used by leaders in this context, so as to translate them into the skills and competencies recognized in secondary research.

The dissertation applied the research philosophy of methodological pragmatism to explore this issue, due to its practical and constructive nature. The approach was inductive and exploratory as it searched for unknown answers of value to leaders operating in a distinctive framework. The research was constructed on a qualitative design, using the multi-case study strategy. The data collection and data analysis were based on methods adapted to the different sample populations and research phases, entailing a multi-levelled data analysis. This process enabled a triangulated validation of the findings.

The research findings, combined with the literature review, highlight that effective leadership in Sudan relates not only to what leaders do, but also to who these leaders are. Contrasting with the intrepid humanitarian saviour, effective leaders in Sudan are systemic thinkers deeply embedded in their context, who can creatively and gradually transcend barriers and constraints. Built on extensive knowledge and cognitive capabilities, their credibility is expressed through a behavioural flexibility that enables the management of multifaceted tensions, leading the organization and its stakeholders towards a common goal.

Table of Contents

ABSTRACT.....	4
GLOSSARY.....	7
CHAPTER 1- INTRODUCTION.....	8
General context	8
Problem definition	8
Research question and objectives	9
CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW	11
LEADERSHIP IN CONTEXT: Critical review and gap analysis.....	11
Leadership in its organizational context: A leader-follower relationship:.....	12
Leadership in its external environment: A strategic relationship.....	13
Contextual leadership:	15
LEADING IN CONTEXT: A matter of authentic flexibility	15
Constraining contexts:	17
Situational strength: How the context impacts authentic flexibility	17
THE HUMANITARIAN CONTEXT: A strenuous and nebulous landscape	18
HUMANITARIAN LEADERSHIP: From inclusive expectations to contextual needs	21
CONCLUSION.....	23
CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	25
RESEARCH PHILOSOPHY:.....	25
RESEARCH DESIGN	27
Research strategy:.....	27
Research method:	27
DATA ANALYSIS	32
Phase 1: Contextual analysis.....	32
Phase 2: Analysis of data on behaviours and coping mechanisms.	33
RESEARCH ETHICS:	35
RESEARCH LIMITATIONS	35
CHAPTER 4: RESEARCH FINDINGS.....	36
PHASE 1: The situational strength of Sudan	36
Clarity of the work-related requirements.....	36
Consistency between the different work-related requirements.....	37
Constraining forces of work-related requirement.....	37
Consequence of constraints on results.....	38

Conclusion.....	39
PHASE 2: Effective mechanisms and behaviours used by leaders in Sudan	39
CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS.....	45
RECOMMENDATIONS.....	51
REFLECTION ON THE DISSERTATION PROCESS	52
Bibliography	53
ANNEXES	64
ANNEX 1: Proactive Influence Tactics	65
ANNEX 2: Humanitarian Principles	66
ANNEX 3: Situational Strength Data Compilation.....	67
ANNEX 4: Behaviours and Mechanisms Data Compilation.....	73

GLOSSARY

ALNAP: Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in Humanitarian Action

ECHO: European Community Humanitarian Aid Department

GHA: Global Humanitarian Assistance

HAC: Humanitarian Aid Commission of Sudan

IASC: Inter-Agency Standing Committee on humanitarian affairs

ICC: International Criminal Court

IHL: International Humanitarian Law

INGOs: International Non-Governmental Organizations

IRIN: Integrated Regional Information Network

Remote Management Programming: The practice of withdrawing international staff and transferring programmatic responsibilities to local staff or local partners

SDC: Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation

CHAPTER 1- INTRODUCTION

General context

Sudan is a bewildering working environment. The intricacy of its conflict (Sahlin, et al., 2012), the unpredictable movement of armed forces, the constant emergence of predicaments and the threat to humanitarian workers (ICC, 2013) keep leaders on edge. The complexity of Sudan is increased by a muscular governmental sovereignty on administrative and operational decision-making processes that are regulated by strict joint-procedures policies (SDC, 2012). This influence compels organizations to develop conformist strategies (HAC, 2013) and perform with a limited pool of competent staff¹ - be they national or expatriates-, within a tightly controlled operational window that frames programs in restricted authorized fields of intervention, whilst denying access to distressed areas (SDC, 2012).

As typically found in protracted crises, the humanitarian setting of Sudan requires both emergency and development responses. Whilst these different types of interventions demand distinct leadership skills and competencies, humanitarian leaders in Sudan are expected to perform in an integrated and multifaceted operational platform (Harmer & Macrae, 2004).

The contextual complexity faced by humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan is, by no means, unique (Amstrong, et al., 2014). Rather, the broad research into this issue shows that such contexts are becoming a norm. It entails that the humanitarian sector needs to assimilate this new paradigm in a way that provides practical responses on the best operational approaches. Also, the probability that this operational framework requires specific leadership abilities needs to be explored in order to understand how humanitarian leaders are to operate effectively within such a context.

Problem definition

Inadequate leadership performance is defined as one of the principal hindrances to the efficiency of humanitarian interventions (Taylor, et al., 2012; Hailey, 2006; Buchanan-Smith & Scriven, 2011). Attempts to identify appropriate leadership formats have been at the center of studies during the last decade. The extensive range of demanding and often contradictory skills, competencies and behaviours recommended by these researches ultimately yields a rather nebulous blueprint of what constitutes effective humanitarian leadership.

¹ National staff are selected and recruited by national systems - the procedures to employ expatriate staff are considerably intense, lengthy and difficult.

Whilst Haley (2006) states that the effectiveness of humanitarian leaders is “in part determined by the environment in which they work” (p. 8), research into the skills and competencies of humanitarian leaders has not yet integrated the new landscape in which these individuals evolve.

Considering the pervasive nature of this trend, it becomes urgent to retackle the research into humanitarian leadership so as to provide humanitarian leaders with practical cues on their working environment and on the appropriate leadership behaviours and skills required to perform effectively.

As Sudan offers an example of this new humanitarian environment, this research proposes to explore its reality and define the appropriate leadership behaviours and skills required to work efficiently in this specific context.

Research question and objectives

The underlying research question posed for this dissertation is:

What, in practice, are the principal competencies and skills needed for a humanitarian leader to be effective in the Sudanese context?

The question seeks to probe if the humanitarian context of Sudan calls for specific leadership behaviors or aptitudes. It focuses on what leaders actually do and on the coping-mechanisms they apply, however theoretically unorthodox that body of practice might turn out to be.

The objectives of this research are therefore to understand how the contextual framework of Sudan affects the display of leadership and to identify the leadership mechanisms used that ensure results and performance. These objectives are detailed as follows:

- Critically review the relevant literature in order to examine existing views or theories on leadership in context;
- Identify and evaluate the influence of the main contextual factors on the work, the conduct and the freewill of humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan, and define its situational strength;
- Identify and analyse comparable effective coping mechanisms (behaviours and styles) used by leaders when adapting to these contexts;
- Bridge these findings with the skills and competencies required to develop such behaviour and styles as found in the literature review.

The researcher's three years of experience in Sudan and her interaction with numerous humanitarian leaders created an early awareness of the difficulties faced by those leading interventions in the country. However, this invaluable experience could readily issue in prejudice and subjectivity on the

researcher's part. The use of specific data gathering and analytic mechanisms should limit such interferences. Objectivity and inclusive sense-making will be a central concern.

The following chapter presents the literature review of leadership in context. It firstly summarises the critical analysis of the academic research on context-based leadership, highlighting the gaps in bridging external contextual realities and related leadership requirements. It will then explore the notions of humanitarian context and leadership, supported by the latest views and studies on these concepts. Finally, the chapter concludes on a brief focus on Sudan and its humanitarian situation.

Chapter three explains the research philosophy, strategy and methodology and justifies the selection of these approaches. It describes the different sample groups, the respective data collection and analytic procedures. The fourth chapter covers the findings through a twofold presentation that defines the situational strength of the Sudanese framework before examining the efficient behaviours and mechanisms used by participants in this context. The final chapter generalises these successful behaviours and mechanisms into specific leadership skills by relating them to the situational strength and relevant academic literature. It will also provide one answer to the research question.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

The aim of the literature review is to understand and reflect on the concept of leadership in context as studied in academic research and in the humanitarian practice domains. It therefore presents a twofold discussion that explores the relationship between contextual factors and the effectiveness of leadership in both fields.

Part one will include relevant academic books and journal articles covering the different theories on leadership in context as well as the works related to the core leadership characteristics required to lead in contemporary contexts. The second part of the review will target published reports, secondary research, books and articles that address the complexity in leading humanitarian interventions in a complex humanitarian landscape. This review will critically analyse the respective views and their complementarities, and highlight the existing gaps in the current studies on leadership in context, whether they be humanitarian-focused or not.

The review process searched different sources:

- The personal MALIC library built up by the researcher
- The Google Scholar Library (related articles and their substantial bibliographies)
- The libraries of humanitarian websites
- Google Search engine based on key terms that progressed throughout the research.

The review starts with the critical analysis of the academic literature on leadership-in-context.

LEADERSHIP IN CONTEXT: Critical review and gap analysis

Bateman and Snell (2004) claim that the effectiveness of leaders is measured by how well their behaviour adapts to situational and temporal contexts. This coincides with Mayo and Nohria (2005) who state that “without the ability to read and adapt to changing (...) conditions, personality and skills are but temporal strengths” (p. 45). Leadership manifests itself in unique and changing situations that call for distinct behaviours and competencies.

Leadership in context is a notion studied throughout the longstanding academic debate on effective leadership. The contextualization is traditionally constructed on two major trend lines: leadership in its organizational context and leadership in its external environment. The latest views on leadership in context, however, advocate for an integrative contextual framework that is “multilevel, multicomponent and interdisciplinary” (Avolio, 2007, p. 31), thereby defining leadership through the interrelation between “the leader, the led and the complexity of the context” (p. 31).

Leadership in its organizational context: A leader-follower relationship:

The study of leadership in its immediate context focuses on the demands and contingencies that shape the interactions between people (Johns, 2006). It refers to the organizational and individual characteristics that influence the display of specific leadership styles and behaviours, such as the readiness of followers and the job at hand (House, 1971; Hersey & Blanchard, 1993; Blanchard, 2008; Fiedler, 1967) or the organizational needs and systems (Quinn, 1988). This study finds its roots in two distinct theories, the contingency theory and the situational leadership theory.

Situational leadership theories as presented by Tannenbaum and Schmidt (1973), House (1971) or Hersey and Blanchard (1993) establish effective leadership as the capacity of leaders to diagnose the readiness of followers and to tailor their behaviours or styles accordingly. Situational leadership calls for flexibility in the display of styles (Peretomode, 2012), suggesting that leaders can -and should- be proficient at shifting their leadership styles as the situation demands.

Rooted in the situational leadership approach, the flexible leadership theory (Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004) is a “theory of strategic leadership” (Yukl, 2008, p. 5) that enlarges the scope of the study by combining both the internal and external context. It calls for a leadership adaptability responding to a large range of variables that determine organizational performance, such as the fast-changing environment or the competing demands from external stakeholders.

Conversely, the contingency theory as developed by Fiedler (1976) asserts that leaders have a natural style where effectiveness is determined through the leader’s interaction with a combination of organizational factors. This theory proposes to “match the man to the situation” (Fiedler, 1976, p. 6). This more inflexible approach to leadership suggests that task and relationship motivators are not “easily changed” and therefore require a specific leadership style (Peretomode, 2012).

Whilst this theory still mobilizes considerable interest, fitting a person to the job is, in recent views, not so much a matter of “what” needs to be done but “how” things should be done, introducing the competency modeling system. This methodology aligns the competences, skills and knowledge of leaders with the demands of the objectives of the task at hand. It emphasizes human assets as a key competitive advantage that can be critical for success, enhancing the individual characteristics of leaders and their “behavioural repertoire” (Howard, 2007, p. 19). Intrinsic characteristics differentiate the competency of individuals, ultimately predicting future behaviours (McClelland & Boyatzis, 1982).

These two contrasting views on the management of the context draw attention to the fact that individual characteristics as well as flexibility are important. In a fast-changing world often described as uncertain or ambiguous, internal situations are, however, unlikely to be sustained for any period of time (Maira & Scott-Morgan, 1997). Versatile leadership is increasingly considered as a core leadership skill that enables the organization to face strategic discontinuities and rapid changes, managing the balance between competing tensions as well as internal flexibility and stability (De Wit & Meyer, 2010; Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004).

The in-depth focus given to the leader-follower relationship in New theories initially built a rather context-free account. Yet, the ways internal or external environments affect or moderate the emergence and salience of new leadership styles eventually challenged the abilities of Transformational heroes (Boal & Hooijberg, 2001). The integration of soft contingencies progressively materialized in these normative studies under the appreciation that leaders are “subject to the forces that affect the system” (Gardner, 1990, p. 1).

Marion and Uhl-Bien (2001) conclude that, “leaders are one element of an interactive network that is far bigger than they” (p. 414). Effective leadership is not only a matter of individual competencies, but is defined by how leaders will use them to interact with the different stakeholders, the diverse environments, and with the realities of time and history. Context has thus become a core element of leadership (Avolio, 2007).

Leadership in its external environment: A strategic relationship

The study of leadership in its external context essentially analyses how such a context influences organizational behaviours (Johns, 2006). The significance of the environments in which organizations are embedded is underlined by Pfeffer and Salancik (2003), who emphasize the dependence of organizations on the constraints and control wielded by their social contexts. Considering the significant weight of these prominent factors on organizational decision-making (Senior & Swales, 2010), the academic discussion on the importance of external contexts seems mostly to concentrate on the impact that these factors have on organizational positioning and on strategies.

Consequently, the academic study of leadership and the external organizational environment essentially examines the strategic leadership “of” organizations (Boal & Hooijberg, 2001), relating to their growth and performance. The diagnosis of external factors informs leaders on how the organization as a whole can best “act upon, enact or adapt” to its external context or trends (Miller & Friesen, 1982, p. 1020).

Whilst numerous tools provide leaders with means to define how and where to best position their organization for future performance within a targeted industry (Senior & Swailes, 2010; Wootton & Horne, 2010; Porter, 2008; Williams, 2013; Pugh, 2011; Kim & Mauborgne, 2005), the influence of these external factors on leadership development or behaviours is poorly evaluated. Partial exceptions to this shortcoming can be found with Hofstede and Schwartz or Turnbull-James and Ladkin, who propose different but complementary answers on the ways external contexts influence leadership expressions.

The works of Hofstede (1980) and Schwartz (1992) suggest that the search for a generic leadership format is likely to prove to be in vain, considering the influence that socio-cultural environments have on leadership and management functions and processes. The combination of these theories provides an inclusive concern for both national behaviours or practices (Hofstede, 1980) and national values (Schwartz, 1992). The study of cross-cultural differences, however, addresses the need to adjust organizational leadership and systems to the cultural values of members (House, et al., 2004; Trompenaar & Wooliams, 2003). It thereby confines the initial theory to the leader-follower relationship, rather than on the influence of national contexts on leadership expressions.

Turnbull-James and Ladkin (2008) draw attention to the fact that leadership territory is not confined to organizational boundaries. Leaders must perceive, interpret and prioritize the external organizational components so as to manage the interest, values and strategies of different ranges of external stakeholders. To these strategic leadership competences, these authors add that in order to create a more favorable long term environment, leaders must also connect to external factors and manoeuvre them through appropriate communication styles and behaviours.

These theories assist leaders in developing an in-depth awareness of the cultural and competitive dynamics so as to influence strategic direction or organizational change accordingly. Yet, less attention is given to the complex impact these external triggers have on leadership conduct. Also, the interaction between internal and external contexts and their combined effect on leadership development fails to appear in these theories. This limits the understanding of leadership in unstable, complex or uncertain environments.

Such situations require a leadership approach that adjusts to the changing variables of unforeseen or demanding circumstances (Kutz, 2008). The recent conception of 'contextual leadership' seeks to address this by connecting leaders to their global context in a structured and culturally sensitive way.

Contextual leadership:

The recent emergence of the 'contextual leadership' theory relates to the increasing volatility of the external environment (Kutz, 2008). Contextual leadership is strongly related to the idea of contextual intelligence, defined by Kutz (2013) and Nye (2008) as the ability to understand, align and respond to changing situations and uncertain environments in a creative manner. This ability is built on a threefold foundation that comprises intuition, knowledge and intelligence, presuming that by merging cognitive capabilities and experience, leaders can identify and seize opportunities arising from each new situation. The notion of transferability as suggested by these authors indicates that a leader with contextual intelligence can perform in all contexts. This view is not shared by Mayo and Nohria (2005) who argue that, in addition to contextual intelligence, individual underlying characteristics also have an impact on contextual leadership performance. McClelland (1982) joins Mayo and Nohria (2005) in arguing that the ability to perform in a specific situation or mandate is indeed rooted in the motives, traits, self-concept, knowledge and skills of a person. Whilst contextual intelligence clearly matters, traits will interact with the context, the nature of which will then influence the emergence of leadership (Avolio, 2007). In conclusion, some leaders are a better fit for specific contexts than others.

The interaction between these situational and dispositional forces builds contextual leadership (Dalal, et al., 2012). Contextual leadership is seen by Macris (2006) as a "way to understand the dynamics of leadership and leadership responsibilities" and designed for "real-world leaders" (p. 2). This concept emphasizes the need to secure a fit between individual leadership characteristics such as personal qualities and character, the way one functions within a context and an individual's competencies and experience within the same context. For Macris, the de-mystified effective leader is simply the right person for the situation.

Contextual leadership therefore bridges the early contingency with situational views as it combines flexible leadership within a pre-defined leadership format that corresponds to a specific context. Whilst the appropriate leadership frame is a situational matter, flexible leadership does, however, require specific skills and competences.

LEADING IN CONTEXT: A matter of authentic flexibility

Flexible leadership is related to flexibility in thoughts and in tactics. Flexibility in thoughts is the ability to maintain an open-minded connection with the evolving situation in order to react to threats or opportunities appropriately. It therefore suggests an aptitude for a system thinking mode to capture the inclusive picture, a hypothesis-driven analysis of the situation and its components, and a social

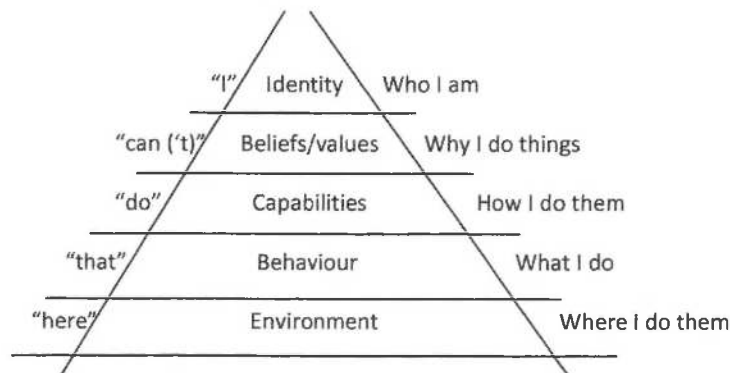
intelligence that can promote objectivity and empathy. Flexible leadership is thus rooted in self-awareness and a willingness to learn (Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004; Liedtka, 1998).

Flexibility in tactics is the capacity to deal with the complexity of a multifaceted or evolving situation by shifting roles and behaviours accordingly. This customized leadership conveys changes through appropriate communication and actions. It requires interpersonal skills to connect with individual motivators and agendas and apply the suitable approach. The review of the comprehensive list of "proactive influence tactics" (annex1) by Yukl (2007, p. 109) does, however, provoke questions on how authenticity can prevail in such maneuverings.

Flexible leadership and communication could therefore present tensions in self-management as well as in the display of authentic leadership, considered by Bennis as an essential trait to "analyze the context and transcend it" (2009, p. 16).

Authentic leadership "is about uniqueness", about being oneself (Puente, et al., 2007, p. 12). Characterized by objectivity, morals, transparency and self-management (Avolio, et al., 2009), authentic leaders develop their own styles and set of behaviours that are consistent with personal values, principles and personality (George, 2005). It therefore requires learning, knowing and acting upon individual levels of influence, so as to remain authentic whilst evaluating how inner and outer attributes can best be used (Hayes, 2005).

Figure 1: Levels of Influence



Source: (Hayes, 2005)

The appreciation of personal levels of influence enables leaders to express their leadership with an intrinsic integrity based on self-awareness, sincerity and maturity. For Bennis (2009, p. 35), integrity prevents a leader from "trim(ming) his or her principles, or even ideas, to please". This view is

strengthened by (George, 2005) who asserts that authentic leaders “refuse to compromise” (p. 4) when their values are tested.

Consistent authenticity enables leaders to face ambiguity and to maintain a purpose-centered path towards the defined goals whilst displaying congruent and aligned values and behaviours that adjust to new realities (Puente, et al., 2007). The effectiveness of versatile leaders is thus essentially based on their authenticity as it conveys trust and credibility (Yukl, 2007). Becoming such a leader is a self-learned process, built on the will to learn and which develops with experience and practice (Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004). Consistent authenticity is, however, at risk when in constraining contexts.

Constraining contexts:

In constraining contexts, the environment becomes an actor of importance rather than an influential factor. It takes a central role in strategic choices as it forces organizations “into a pattern in its stream of action, regardless of the presence of central controls” (Mintzberg & Waters, 1985, p. 268). This “limits, disables or complicates incumbents from executing their responsibilities” (Lam, 1996, p. 181). The level of organizational compliance with constraining contexts is, however, a matter of discretion. Indeed, the viability of organizations depends not only on their capacity to adapt to such external constraints but also on their ability to stabilize the structure by progressively identifying if, where and how the environment can be enacted, so as to reduce uncertainty and pressures (Pfeffer & Salancik, 2003). Enacting constraining contexts entails that leaders have identified room for leadership maneuvering, and are aware of the situational strength of their context.

Situational strength: How the context impacts authentic flexibility

The ‘situational strength’ of the context in which this leadership is exerted informs the ways leadership characteristics can be expressed. Meyer et al (2010) define situational strength as the “implicit or explicit cues provided by external entities regarding the desirability of potential behaviours” (p. 122). Strong situational strength induces the situational force to prevail over the individual dispositional force, thereby restricting leadership characteristics and behaviours. Such strengths cause “everyone to construe the particular event in the same way, inducing uniform expectancies regarding the most appropriate response pattern” (Mischell, 1977, p. 347) by providing “clear cues about what that situation demands” (Cooper & Withey, 2010). Conversely, weak situational strength enhances and brings personal dispositions into play in unclear situations (Dalal, et al., 2012; Mullins & Cummings, 1999). In sum, the context matters more in strong situations whilst personalities matter more in weak situations (Mischell, 1977).

Situational strengths are, for Meyer et al (2010), based upon four facets: the clarity, consistency, constraints and consequences (4Cs) of work-related requirements. *Clarity* relates to the availability and comprehension of cues on responsibilities and requirements, ultimately defining clear procedures, a salient climate and unambiguous expectations of appropriate behaviours. *Consistency* refers to the mutual compatibility of these requirements and responsibilities, bringing coherence over time amongst the different sources of information, and thereby suggesting a specific and similar expected course of action. *Constraints* are the forces that limit the expression of individual freedom on decisions or actions, such as internal or national policies. Finally, *consequences* refer to the scale of negative or positive outcomes of decisions and actions, meaning that the threat of negative effects will induce specific behaviours.

Although Mischell (1977) argued that weak situations indicate a lack of clarity, strong situations can, on the other hand, be more demanding and stressful due to the strain put on natural cognitive and behavioural inclinations (Shoda, et al., 1993). The later collective work of both authors concludes that the actual influence of situations vary on the basis of individual perceptions (Shoda & Mischel, 2000). This could indicate that the strength of a situation is understood and managed on the basis of individual sensitivity and inclination, and is therefore influenced by the initial dispositional characteristics of a person. Thus, whilst the situational strength has an impact on the expression of personality and therefore on actual behaviours, individual dispositions do have an effect on the situation and its outcomes. The impact is reciprocal. A similar situation can not only be perceived but also be developed differently on the basis of individual nature and predispositions.

The situational strength of humanitarian conflict-based contexts is a matter defined through the analysis of particular influential factors, including the 4cs noted above. This said, the critical review of the research on the general trends in the humanitarian landscape depicts an emerging and rather constraining general setting.

THE HUMANITARIAN CONTEXT: A strenuous and nebulous landscape

The humanitarian context is categorized as an emergency-based environment labeled either as fragile, insecure, rapidly changing or complex, that requires actions that will save lives, alleviate suffering and protect human dignity (GHA, 2014; Egeland, et al., 2011; Amstrong, et al., 2014).

Initially, support supplied along the traditional 'emergency'- 'early recovery'- 'development' aid continuum provided aid actors, donors and host countries with a progressive frame that led the country

from humanitarian responses to a developmental assistance, ultimately creating a reformed state of law (Macrae, 2001). This is no longer the case. The surge of protracted conflicts (OCHA, 2013; Ferris, 2011) prolongs the need for humanitarian aid in increasingly fragile and semi-permanent situations whilst introducing developmental aid in defined areas (Amstrong, et al., 2014).

Recently, the standardized conceptualization of the humanitarian context has become more and more related to protracted conflict-based crises defined by persistent political or diplomatic instabilities, ongoing or recent conflicts, thereby creating an absence of rules of law and a vulnerability to a range of risks (Amstrong, et al., 2014; Harmer & Macrae, 2004). This prolonged vulnerable status renders humanitarian organizations more exposed to the rise of assertive voices from donor countries and host governments who affirm their respective control and sovereignty ever more strongly, ultimately turning aid into a political tool (Amstrong, et al., 2014; Curtis, 2001).

Whilst the politicization of humanitarian action is nothing new (Curtis, 2001), it is increasingly visible at three levels. Firstly, the expanding engagement of donor countries in conflict-based crisis through aid funding (Slim, 2012) indicates an intensified concern, be it related to political, economic or security issues (Harmer & Macrae, 2004; Kent, et al., 2013). Secondly, by interfering through aid in politically charged contexts, humanitarian organizations are integrated into these contexts, and into the conflict, thereby inevitably influencing the political economy of war (Anderson, 1999). Finally, whilst humanitarian assistance is increasingly subject to political conditionality and the legitimization of host countries, conflict-based crises are gradually becoming more domestic than international (Regnier, 2011; Collinson & Elhawary, 2012). Domestic conflicts are not only about occupation or control. Their ultimate purpose is the definition of the national identity, entailing that the host state is usually integrated in the conflict (Macrae, 2001). This increases the risk that aid be delivered on the basis of political interest rather than need (Macrae & Leader, 2000; Werker & Ahmed, 2008) as humanitarian aid is conditioned by “political, military and civilian actors who can (...) facilitate but also manipulate or obstruct humanitarian action” (Bernard, 2011, p. 893).

Thus, the “de facto hegemony” (Amstrong, et al., 2014, p. 17) that previously provided Western humanitarian organizations with an operational autonomy and a detachment from thorny contextual realities has shifted towards the obligation to comply with the distinctive political agendas of stakeholders. The operational ability and security of INGOs is now embedded in their capacity to understand not only their operating context but also *how* their mandate, their role and their presence are perceived. It is on the basis of this understanding that they might develop apposite “calculated

approaches” that are accepted and sustained by the various national and international parties (Amstrong, et al., 2014, p. 3).

The necessity for humanitarians to comply and engage constructively with imposed and sometimes contradictory regulations has a direct impact on the mandate, the strategy and the modus operandi of relief organizations. First, it thereby defines the boundaries and the aims of interventions in a context over which these organizations have little control (Egeland, et al., 2011). It can also threaten the essence of humanitarian assistance that finds its roots in humanitarian principles (annex 2). Instead, an instrumental rationality now prevails, where applications could be traded for operational access (Amstrong, et al., 2014; Collinson & Elhawary, 2012). Finally, it creates isolated “implicit deals with belligerents” (Collinson & Elhawary, 2012, p. 3) and an individual strategic adjustment so as to access the funds of donors (Easterly & Williamson, 2011). This last adaptation is defined by Werker and Ahmed (2008) as the “only market-force of non-government sector industry” (p. 8). This competitive landscape unavoidably encourages what might be termed as secluded fitting strategies that affect cohesion amongst humanitarian organizations as a whole. It is an approach that weakens their individual and collective positioning, and therefore their negotiation strengths (Taylor, et al., 2012).

Humanitarian organizations can no longer base their action on traditional “state-avoiding” humanitarian aid policy (Harmer & Macrae, 2004, p. 6). The acknowledgement of this fact will enable them to draw the needed caveats and establish their own principled standards for action before defining “how to engage and influence all key actors involved so as to promote a more humanized politics and a more effective humanitarian action” (Collinson & Elhawary, 2012, p. 4). Such a position would also enable them to develop partnerships with the recipient parties. A delicate balance needs to be found between what is expected to be done, what should be done and what can be done, interrelating ethics, politics and operations (Slim, 2003). It requires an in-depth understanding of the coding, rules and systems of host countries (Amstrong, et al., 2014).

At national level, promoting humane politics can be a hazardous process if the local culture, laws and regulations are neither considered nor integrated in the reflection. Considering that conflicts predominantly occurred in Muslim-majority countries this last decade (IRIN, 2014) and that the majority of aid beneficiaries worldwide are Muslims (Hyder, 2007), the understanding of Islamic culture and laws becomes a fundamental tool in humanitarian advocacy and negotiations.

In the Muslim world, humanitarianism is viewed as an act of worship. It is an essential component of Islam and its practice is mandatory in Quranic texts (Krafess, 2005). Islamic laws and war laws are deeply engrained in the Quran and in the Traditions of Prophet Muhammad. These texts include the notions of humanity, of restraint and of mercy to the vulnerable (Aly, 2014). However, the progressive influences of Muslim scholars have developed these laws into a wide range of distinct interpretations, eventually inducing quite different practices of Islamic beliefs (Aly, 2014; Nusrat, 2005).

Understanding the local and individual significance of Islamic laws can have an impact on the outcome of negotiations, on security aspects and on the integration of humanitarian principles into relief interventions. It is however a delicate matter that requires a mutual openness, understanding and engagement (Aly, 2014).

Whilst an overall understanding of the new humanitarian context is valuable, each humanitarian situation is unique as it combines a specific conflict, a particular political context and different levels of vulnerability (Amstrong, et al., 2014); all of these evolve and shift over time. Establishing an effective leadership format within such contexts is, therefore, a complex process.

HUMANITARIAN LEADERSHIP: From inclusive expectations to contextual needs

Leadership effectiveness is at the centre of the debate on the performance of humanitarian interventions (Taylor, et al., 2012; Hailey, 2006). Efforts to define appropriate leadership formats show a growing concern related to the expansion of the humanitarian enterprise and its challenges (Buchanan-Smith & Scriven, 2011). There is equal recognition of the growing complexity of the humanitarian scene in terms of donor expectations and the humanitarian mandate (Steets, et al., 2009; Richardson, 2006; Jayawickrama, 2011); concern also for the clear necessity for leadership improvement (Taylor, et al., 2012; Angus & McNicoll, 2012); and the need for a new form of humanitarian response (IASC, 2012; Angus & McNicoll, 2012).

The broad range of necessary skills, competencies and behaviours revealed by these studies and reports on effective humanitarian leadership evolves along a complex and occasionally contentious continuum. The research calls for systemic strategic and political acumen (Minas, 2005; Kings, 2010; Jayawickrama, 2011), transformational attributes or salient behaviours (Ripoll, et al., 2010; Hailey, 2006), relational (locally) or entrepreneurial (internal) styles (Jayawickrama, 2011; Nilsson, 2011) and furthermore for authentic leadership versus political aptitudes (Hailey, 2006; IASC, 2012). The inclusion of all these

abilities in the traditionally all-embracing job descriptions from organizations propels humanitarian leaders towards a mix of capabilities, talents and expertise of which the overall rationality could be questioned. What truly matters is to define what is needed where, when and how, guiding humanitarian leadership towards a contextual and situational format.

The analysis of the skills and means required to lead effective humanitarian interventions in protracted conflict-based crises is still at its very early stages (Harmer & Macrae, 2004). This is probably due to the recent endorsement of this contextual trend and to the distinctiveness of each crisis. Recent studies of protracted and fragile crises do, however, identify or recommend similar techniques when dealing with these contexts. The following Table 1 underlines some of these actions.

Table 1: Prevailing techniques for contemporary humanitarian contexts

Practices	Means	Effects
Maintain a low profile	Limit visibility, avoid ostentation, favor awareness and responsiveness	Reduce security risks, ease negotiation and acceptance
Develop localized programming	Subcontracting to local or national organizations, strengthening the localization of aid	Facilitate access, reduce security risks and strengthens local appropriation
Create highly localized teams	Appointing national staff from the humanitarian diasporas; recruiting staff locally	Facilitate local negotiation, limits cultural gaps and reduces security risks
Manage by remote	Lead interventions from a distance and decentralize program delivery to local teams in the field	No other choice; prioritize empowerment and development of local members
Build relationship with key stakeholders	Develop an active-acceptance using outreach strategies and participation of local audience	Easier negotiation, get consent; "earn the space";

Sources: (Collinson & Elhawary, 2012; Egeland, et al., 2011; Armstrong, et al., 2014; Slim, 2012)

The effectiveness of these practices depends on different factors. Egeland et al (2011) argue that humanitarian leaders are "unable to negotiate in a strong host state" (2011, p. 38). Also, whilst the implementation of highly localized teams or programming might facilitate local negotiations on access and security, there is a probability that the actual response will become localized as well and is influenced by biased affinities rather than by humanitarian principles (Egeland, et al., 2011; Armstrong, et al., 2014). The mission then goes 'native' and loses its pan-situational mandate. Finally, such processes presume that the local capacity is sufficient, which is rarely the case in fragile contexts. It calls for an acceptance of probable "slower, lower quality services" (Egeland, et al., 2011, p. 21) which might then disrupt contractual agreements with donors. Such an implementation change could create a legitimacy crisis that is barely controllable through the remote management system, considering the cultural and geographical dissociation such a process induces between organizations and the very societies they might seek to assist.

These limitations underline, once again, the influence of the context and its components on the selection of leadership behaviours or mechanisms. In order to establish the type of leadership practices required, one must understand what the targeted humanitarian context is, and how specific it can get.

Humanitarian context in Sudan:

Sudan has been at the center of humanitarian concerns for an extended period of time. Recognized by OCHA (2013) as one of the most established protracted crisis, Sudan ranks second in the top three countries which, along with Afghanistan and Somalia, are considered “extremely violent operational settings” since 2005 (Egeland, et al., 2011, p. 11). Whilst presenting specific characteristics, all three countries are united in facing domestic-based conflicts.

Due to its prolonged and numerous conflicts since 2002, Sudan has been categorized as a ‘fragile state’ with a high vulnerability index score (GHA, 2014). Whilst humanitarian needs are consistently high, the working conditions facing humanitarians operating in Sudan remains constraining for both security and administrative reasons (ECHO, 2014; SDC, 2012). The intense history of warfare and international interventions has generated an entrenched sense of mutual mistrust and a national concern for the continuance of sovereignty. The distinct climate of hostility demonstrated by the authorities against foreign representation, organizations and institutions results in restricted access to areas and assets, in multiple administrative impediments, in increased security risks, and in a disregard or rejection of ‘Western construct’ humanitarian laws and principles (Collinson & Elhawary, 2012; Egeland, et al., 2011).

Whilst such a restrictive situation (posed as a given to humanitarian organizations) has a probable influence on the working environment of leaders, the ways it affects, or fails to shape humanitarian behaviours is an individual matter. In order to define the situational strength of leaders operating in Sudan, these leaders must identify which factors delineate their contextual reality and how this reality impacts their work and behaviours, factors that may eventually call for different leadership traits, skills or competencies.

CONCLUSION

The critical review of academic and humanitarian literature supports the present research as it revealed the significance of context in leadership expressions, behaviours and processes. Moreover, it exposes the interrelation between internal and external situational factors and the subsequent complexity in leading in context. Information essential to this research emerged from the academic literature in that it

attests that effective contextual leadership is not only a matter of competencies or skills, but also a matter of individual characteristics. Likewise, the humanitarian literature provides interesting new contextual perspectives related to the humanitarian landscape and its components. Further studies need to uncover the core leadership characteristics and abilities most appropriate for such a complex context. To this end, the current research could be of use. The discussion turns now to how this Dissertation needs to be enacted, in methodological terms.

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This Chapter describes the philosophy that defines the research and its choice of methodology. The research strategy is explained and the reasons for selecting this approach are specified. The consequences of selecting this method for the body of evidence recognized and deemed significant are set out. The Chapter also identifies methodological alternatives and explicitly gives the reasons for rejecting those alternatives. The reflections in the literature review above illustrate the various sensitivities within the Sudanese context. These place a premium on the ethics of research inquiry. This topic is also therefore discussed below.

RESEARCH PHILOSOPHY:

The research presents a pragmatic applied-research philosophy in the sense that it targets -and indeed follows- the problem by attempting to improve the understanding of *how* leadership performance is influenced by the particular Sudanese context. It thereby seeks to provide a practical answer that is of relevance to humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan, namely, *what* are the skills and competencies required in such a setting (McKensie & Knipe, 2009; Saunders, et al., 2012)? Consequently, Pragmatism is adopted as the most relevant philosophy for this research as it develops a constructive knowledge that informs potential future actions (Goldkuhl, 2012). This pragmatic approach is presented in comparison to other available research philosophies in Table 2 below.

Table 2: Comparison of Research Philosophy Paradigms

PHILOSOPHIES	PRAGMATISM	POSITIVISM	INTERPRETIVISM
Concern	How things work: Intervention and Change	How things are: Observation, Explanation and Prediction	How things are seen: Understanding Beliefs
Pattern	Finding new theories for action	Testing existing theories for Universal Laws	Challenging the idea of theorizing
Type of researcher	Analyst	Scientific	Social actor
Position	Usefulness	Realism	Equivocal
Probabilities are	Interpreted for action	Factual; evidence-based	Multiple
Epistemological Stance	Constructive knowledge	Objective knowledge; Hypothesis testing and Regularisation	Subjective and relative knowledge
Reality based on	Socio-contextual construct	External construct	Individual construct
Process	Open process focused on Research Question	Causal relationship, value- and belief-free	Integration in and understanding of individual social realities
Research methods	Pluralist- based on RQ	Quantitative - rigorous	Qualitative - flexible

Sources: (Braa & Vidgen, 1999; Goles & Hirschheim, 2000; Sahlin, et al., 2012)

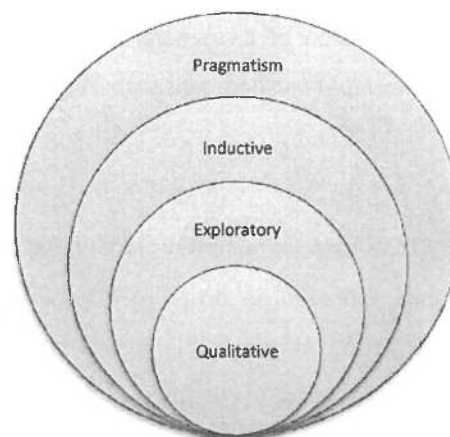
Considering the scarcity of material in the proposed area of this research, this study takes an exploratory form by analysing leadership constructs in a “new light” (Saunders, et al., 2009, p. 138) due to a situation of distinctive complexity. This leads the research towards an inductive path, progressively building a theory on leadership requirements within such contexts.

The pragmatic, exploratory and inductive nature of this study calls for a qualitative approach so as to gain “cognitive access” (Saunders, et al., 2012, p. 163) to the understanding of participants on the means and behaviours needed to lead efficiently in this context. Qualitative information enables the appreciation and interpretation of the “meaning people have constructed” (Merriam, 2009, p. 13), which is essential to the course of this research.

Contrasting with the objectivity and rather inflexible positivism of quantitative designs, qualitative research will target soft facts, exploring and interpreting social constructs. Traditionally related to interpretivism, qualitative research takes a pragmatic direction when the research aims at understanding how the knowledge is created, by exploring the “effects and success of different tactics” (Goldkhuhl, 2012, p. 10). Under the Pragmatic lens, the qualitative research becomes functional.

In conclusion, the philosophy of this research is constructed under the following format.

Figure 2: Summary of the present research philosophy



Sources: (Saunders, et al., 2012; Braa & Vidgen, 1999; Goles & Hirschheim, 2000; McKensie & Knipe, 2009)

RESEARCH DESIGN

This research design describes the practical construction of the investigation, providing information on 'what' is the research strategy, 'how' will this strategy be built and 'why' have such choices been made (Saunders, et al., 2012).

Research strategy:

The strategy of the research focuses on identifying the contextual leadership skills and competencies required to lead effective humanitarian interventions in Sudan. The contextual nature of this research therefore addresses contemporary phenomena in a real-life situation, presented by Yin (1993) as core case-study characteristics. In addition, as planned and conversely to grounded research, a case-study can be guided by conceptual theories that outline its framework and provide an academic meaning to the case findings (Hartley, 1994).

The strategy is therefore based on the case-study of humanitarian leaders, so as to "gain a rich understanding of the *context* and the *processes* being enacted" (Saunders, et al., 2012, p. 179). This entails a twofold data collection and analytic process, primarily focused on the definition of the situational strength before addressing the actual behaviours and mechanisms displayed. Consequently, the strategy is built on a multi-methods process that explores both the context and the behaviours of leaders.

Research method:

The research method includes the presentation of its general approach, the outline of the multi-populations sample, the description of the multi-levelled data gathering methods and the combination of the multi-methods data analysis.

Defining the approach

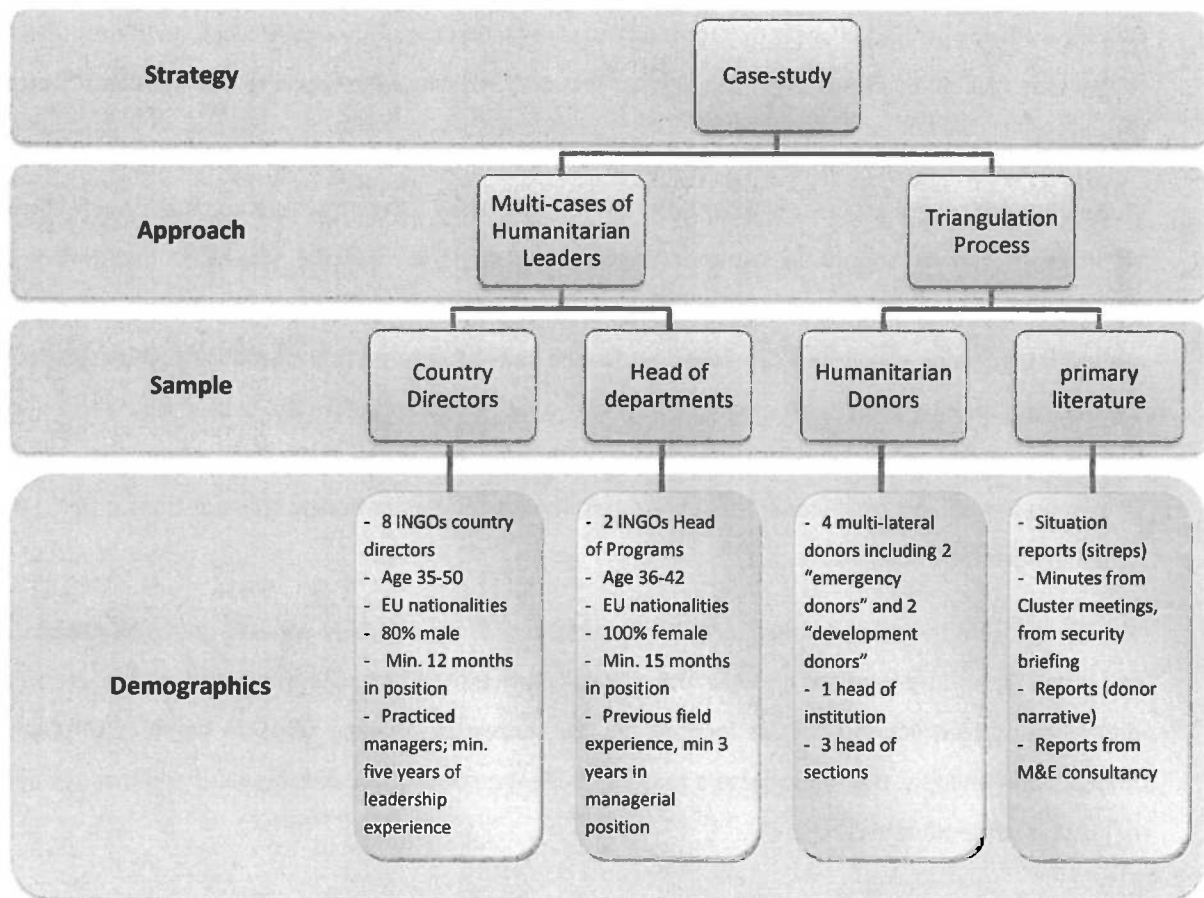
The objective of the research strategy is to identify common perceptions and similar behaviours. The case-study therefore uses a multi-cases approach, in order to draw inferences on consistent data (Bryman, 2004). This multi-cases investigation avoids undue generalization by exploring a range of inputs from various participants, adding a pluralist perspective to this research (Miles & Huberman, 1994).

In addition, the design interrelates the sub-contextual realities faced, and the behavioural processes used by leaders across current realities and constraints (Meyer, 2011). The study of the relation

between these contextual and behavioural components will define the core competencies and skills required to display the expected behaviours, inferring the causality between variables (Fiedler, 1967).

In order to obtain different perspectives on the main contextual factors, the multi-cases analysis of humanitarian leaders is supported by a triangulation constructed on one additional population sampling and on primary literature. This ensures the relevance and objectivity of the results (Saunders, et al., 2012). Therefore, different population samples are targeted, as presented in the figure below.

Figure 3: Multi-level sampling and demography



These population samples were subject to different data gathering processes under a progressive and inclusive construct, detailed in the next section.

Multi-levels data gathering methods

The primary and secondary data converge towards the consolidation of the case-study of humanitarian leaders. The primary data was collected subsequently and differently so as to progressively build the information on the context data collected.

1. Primary data:

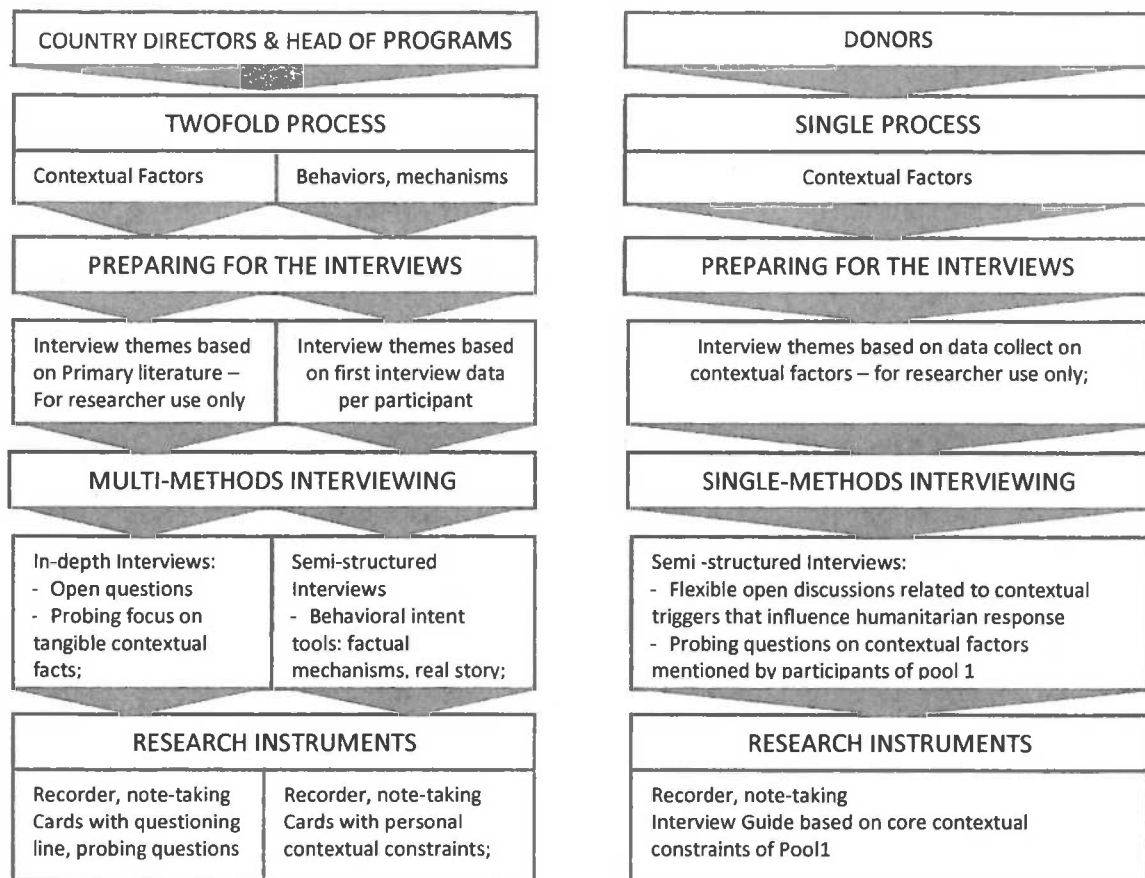
The primary data was gathered through two different pools of participants. The first pool groups the main participants of this case-study, the humanitarian leaders. They committed to a two-fold face-to-face interviewing process in order to inform on the core factors that define their work, on the contextual reality they face and subsequently, the mechanisms and behaviours they use to manage these factors efficiently.

These interviews were processed under different formats. The first context-related interviews followed an in-depth format supported by open probing questions on specific situations mentioned by participants, in order to illustrate comments by tangible facts and avoid abstractions (King, 1994). The second interviewing phase was developed under the semi-structured format that included tools from the Behavioural Intent Interview model (McClelland, 1998) so as to explore the factual mechanisms and behaviours displayed by leaders when dealing with their respective contextual constraints. These interviews focused on “real-stories” that were reframed through fact-finding sub-questions probing the actual behaviours displayed.

The donors form the second pool of primary data. As donors are regularly updated on the development of humanitarian interventions by their operational partners (INGOs), the interviews were conducted under the semi-structured format focused on the contextual analysis so as to confirm, through a triangulation analysis, the major factors that influence the conception, development and management of these interventions in Sudan.

The researcher prepared for the interviews by conducting 3 pilot interviews that are not integrated in the final data. The practice gained by this process improved the introductory phase of interviews and enabled the design of accurate sets of cards with initial and probing questioning lines. Different data gathering methods and research instruments were used throughout the process, as seen in figure 4.

Figure 4: Construct of the primary data gathering process of the research



Source: (King, 1994; Bryman, 2007; Saunders, et al., 2012)

These rather open interviewing formats were chosen so as to avoid framing of reflection of leaders and to prevent any unease due to the sensitivity of the matters discussed. However, probing questions progressively led towards concrete experience and particular feelings, thereby consolidating the information both on practical facts and on inner perceptions. All interviews lasted about one hour and were conducted sequentially between the 22^d of March and the 14th of May 2014. Each level of interviews followed a different questioning line, as suggested in the example below.

Table 3: Questioning line format for Pool 1

POOL 1	Purpose of questioning line for Context-Based Interviews	Relation to topic researched and literature review
Situational strength	Outline the aim of the research, of the format of interview, ethics, agreement on procedure and use of research instruments	Introduction of the aim of the interview and its process, confirmation of agreement on ethics
	Reflection on the working conditions in Sudan Opening question: "So, how is it, working in Sudan?"	Introduction to the first contextual elements
	Reflection the main contextual factors ; Probing questions "Can you tell me more about that", "Why is that?"	Targeting the core of what defines the working context in Sudan
	Reflection on the 4Cs imposed by each factor; Probing questions based on "what", "how", "Why"	Structuring the information; Building the situational strength of Sudan
	Reflection on inner feelings related to the contextual factors	Addressing personal dilemmas, preparing for future discussion on authenticity and ethics
Behaviours and Mechanisms	Reflection on individual contextual factors and on means found to deal with them; "can you tell me how you "; real-stories; Open-probing questions: "What, how, why did you..?" "how does it work?" "why?"	Identifying efficient coping mechanisms and behaviours leaders use to face the Sudanese situational strength Structuring the information for logical and chronological data
	Reflection on personal feelings, ethical consideration; "what really matters here?." "how do you cope with...", ...	Searching for information on integrity and authenticity, probing for feelings, thoughts and actions during events
	Confirmation of core factors: "what would be the main advice you would give to your replacement?"	Focusing on the core contextual and behavioural elements

Secondary Data:

The secondary data was searched for insights into the implementation of relief interventions in Sudan, the strategies used, and the constraints or opportunities faced. The choice of documentation consisted of:

- Primary literature: reports to donors or from commissioned monitoring missions; situation reports ("sitreps"); minutes from Clusters meetings and from security briefings; contractual engagements (Technical Agreements); policy documents.
- Secondary literature: Publications by professional bodies and associations, humanitarian censuses, research and analysis of humanitarian leadership episodes and studies on Sudan as a context-sensitive framework.

The next section presents the methods used and the coding system created for the analysis of the gathered data.

DATA ANALYSIS

Each interview has been transcribed on separate documents in which all personal details have been deleted and replaced by specific code. These documents have been reworked progressively through different highlighting systems, first individually then in an inclusive manner. The analysis of data follows the pattern of the data collection and is built on a two-phase process.

Phase 1: Contextual analysis

The first phase of the research aims at assessing and establishing the situational strength of the working context as perceived by humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan. This initial step has proven to be a hazardous process considering that there is “no agreed on way to conceptualize or measure” the construct space of situational strength (Meyer, et al., 2010, p. 137).

In the absence of methods to evaluate situational strengths, the risk of an analytic bias or generalization based on a simplistic appraisal of the data is real. To strengthen the validity of the situational strength evaluation, the coding system for such analysis must be targeted, integrated and levelled (Meyer, et al., 2010).

Coding system

The extensive study on the practicability of the situational strength concept done by Meyer et al. (2010) provides a useful prior framework for this Dissertation in its efforts to measure situational strength. The first contextual analysis is therefore based on an initial coding system (Sahlin, et al., 2012) that takes into account the four C-dimensions presented by these authors. Therefore, the Clarity, Consistency, Constraints and Consequences of work-related requirements will be used to evaluate the transversal factors that define the situation of leaders. This coding system enables the researcher to focus on facts, preventing emotional interpretations of data and comments.

This first analysis focuses on explicit information consistent with the research question, appraising the strength of the situation, specifically: “how do leaders perceive work-related requirements and expectations in terms of clarity, consistency, constraints and consequences?”. These requirements and expectations are analysed through a multifaceted construct, so as to establish the strength of these dimensions across sub-level influential factors that emerge as the core contextual causes that shape the behaviour of leaders in Sudan. The coding format is presented in the following table.

Table 4: Coding frame of contextual sub-factors

REQUIREMENTS	Level of CLARITY		Level of CONSISTENCY		Level of CONSTRAINTS		Level of CONSEQUENCES	
	Are the work-related requirements clear?		Are they compatible?		Do they restrict action and behaviour choices?		Do they induce a pressure on outcomes?	
FACTOR 1	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low
FACTOR 2	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low
FACTOR 3	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low	High	Low

Source: adapted from (Meyer, et al., 2010)

The situational strength of the work-related frame of humanitarian leaders will be defined through a comprehensive analysis on how these factors build on each other, ultimately highlighting the general strengths or weaknesses of the situation.

Phase 2: Analysis of data on behaviours and coping mechanisms.

The analysis of behaviours and mechanisms used by leaders accounts for patterns of traits, skills and behaviours that are effective in Sudan, highlighting the criterion referenced competencies that lead to effective performance (McClelland & Boyatzis, 1982).

The coding of this second phase is developed in two steps. The first step summarizes individual behaviours and mechanisms directly related to performance. It evolves from an initial to a focused and conceptualized coding (Saunders, et al., 2012) so as to allow further comparisons. It is based on a tabulation of variables that is progressively constructed on the analysis of multiple tabulated cross-sheets developed by themes and by participants. This highlighted the core and underlying variables by individual, such as presented in the example below.

Table 5: Individual coding tabulation on successful behaviours and mechanisms

P1 Topics coding	Mechanism		Behaviours	
NATIONAL				
Issue 1	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2
Issue 2	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2
DONOR				
Issue 1	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2
Issue 2	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2
HR				
Issue 1	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2
Issue 2	Mechanism 1	General approach	Behaviour 1	Characteristic 1
	Mechanism 2		Behaviour 2	Characteristic 2

The final tabulation is constructed on a selective coding system (Saunders, et al., 2012) that gathers the replicated issues through mechanisms and behavioural units. This final tabulation has been built through the cross-referencing of individual focused data, ultimately selecting principal topics that consistently emerged in the interviews. This tabulation was built under the following frame.

Table 6: General tabulation of core successful behaviours and mechanisms

Final coding		PARTICIPANTS	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
MECHANISMS										
National	TOPIC 1 (ex:compliance)	Mechanism1	X		X "..."	X	X	X "..."		X
		Mechanism 2	...							
	TOPIC 2	Mechanism 1								
		Mechanism 2								
Donor	TOPIC 1	Mechanism 1								
		Mechanism 2								
	TOPIC 2	Mechanism 1								
		Mechanism 2								
HR	TOPIC 1	Mechanism 1								
		Mechanism 2								
	TOPIC 2	Mechanism 1								
BEHAVIOURS										
National	TOPIC 1	Behaviour 1	X "..."	X			X "..."	X	X	X
		Behaviour 2	...							
	TOPIC 2	Behaviour 1								
		Behaviour 2								
Donor	TOPIC 1	Behaviour 1								
		Behaviour 2								
	TOPIC 2	Behaviour 1								
		Behaviour 2								
HR	TOPIC 1	Behaviour 1								
		Behaviour 2								
	TOPIC 2	Behaviour 1								

Overall, the sense-making of data is a built-in process that progressively relates direct behavioural evidence to situational strength characteristics. This process uses tools from the Behavioural Event Interview (BEI) model in the sense that it focuses on the motives that justify attitudes and mechanisms

and establish the attributability of similar techniques to specific contextual needs (McClelland, 1998). The sense-making of data is however focused on analogous situational trends rather than on chronic individual conducts based on personal beliefs or values, thereby distancing itself from the BEI model (McClelland, 1998).

RESEARCH ETHICS:

The sensitivity of the research topic is related to the risk taken by interviewees in expressing their appreciation of contextual factors and the systems they use to face them, due to preceding governmental intransigent reactions to open displays of personal opinions by members of the humanitarian community. An oral agreement of confidentiality was made with all participants who were reassured by the further steps planned by the researcher to ensure the protection of the data. These steps included the coding of all transcripts, the removal of names or places, and the transfer of the recordings onto a personal USB stick until their final deletion, at the end of the analysis.

RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

The main limitation of this research is that its sample populations comprise only Western leaders and donors who accepted to participate to this research. This unintended sampling selection limits the findings to a rather homogeneous cultural view, thereby influencing the results of the research and limiting its generalization (Meyer, et al., 2010).

Also, as the researcher had no access to field areas, the sample focuses on participants based in Khartoum, the Sudanese capital city. The cultural biases noted by researchers like Hofstede et al (see Chapter 2) may then prove of significance here. However, country directors are well aware of and deeply engaged in the global complexity of leading interventions throughout Sudan. Their nuanced judgements may thus offset many of these rural-urban divisions.

Through personal experience, the researcher has built her own opinion on the problem stated. Biases and subjectivity based on these pre-understandings (Gummesson, 1988) could have influenced the interviewing and analysis processes. The decision to design scrupulous coding formats and to process the data under a triangulation method enabled the rationalization of the information with a more distant and potentially objective view on the problems studied (Saunders, et al., 2012).

CHAPTER 4: RESEARCH FINDINGS

This Chapter will present the results and the classification of the situational strength of the working context of participants, and analyze the ensuing effective coping mechanisms and behaviours used.

PHASE 1: The situational strength of Sudan

The first phase of this research evaluates the situational strength of the working context and focuses on the perception of leaders on the clarity, consistency, constraints and consequences of their work-related requirements. These requirements emanate from the main influential sub-factors that define the contextual reality of leaders in Sudan. Three factors consistently emerged from the interviews:

- The control enacted by national authorities on humanitarian affairs;
- The limited access to, and performance of qualified human resource;
- The complex funding systems of donors.

Each of these factors imposes distinctive and often diverging work-related requirements, preventing the formation of a consistent frame of action, behaviours or skills. The initial perception of this general context therefore outlines, *at first sight*, a weak situational strength. Leaders appear to operate in a complex social system that interferes with the characteristics of strong situations, expressed through clear consistent cues on what is expected (Mischell, 1977). Yet, the coding system used for the research enabled a detailed analysis of these factors, providing results that question this assumption.

Clarity of the work-related requirements

The description of the contextual reality by leaders shows that they are generally well aware of what is expected from them, whether from focal donors or from different governmental bodies. The strategies of these donors present individual prerequisites and expectations that are clearly stated and made to provide leaders with unambiguous formats for appeals.

At governmental level, the overall control on humanitarian operations is expressed through unequivocal requirements and demands, calling for explicit protocols, behaviours and actions. But, as one participant states, leaders “know the music” (P2-31.66).

The requirements related to the management of staff appear clear for leaders, whether they have expatriate teams in the field or not. Leaders agree on the limited capacity of national staff and on the shortfall in expatriate technicians and managers to support them, compelling them to personally focus on the “general management of issues” at central level (P5-09.41). This, along with the restriction on

travel due to security or governmental constraints, affects their presence in, and support to the field. More satisfaction is found in leaders who can avoid the remote-management system due to the presence of expatriate base-managers in the field.

Despite evident efforts to provide the needed consideration to foreign or national staff, leaders delegate “with strict control” (P7-28.10) supported by precise planning, monitoring and communication tools.

Consistency between the different work-related requirements

The *consistency* in and across the requirements of donors and national authorities is strongly lacking. At donor level, all leaders and two donors stress evident disparities amongst the expectations, strategies and operational regulations of the funding institutions in Sudan. Although this lack of cohesion and collaboration eases, in some ways, the compliance with individual demands through specific behaviours and actions, it entails constant timely adjustments to institutional and individual expectations, whilst attempting to maintain a cohesive program.

More importantly, leaders state that stakeholder divergence prevents them from securing the link between relief and rehabilitation responses, considered as of “paramount importance” for sustainable results (Georgieva, K. European Commissioner for International Cooperation, Humanitarian Aid and Crisis Response, cited in (Bernard, 2011, p. 903) and which is, by definition, specific to protracted crisis (Harmer & Macrae, 2004).

At governmental level, whilst the pressure imposed by the requirements of national authorities is consistent, the articulation of these pressures seems to differ greatly whether at federal, state or local levels, generally depending on the individual sitting behind the desk. Behaviours and patterns of communication therefore will vary.

The degree of collaboration between donors and governmental bodies can be questioned considering the disparities mentioned by leaders and donors in terms of targeted priority areas that are barely accessible, of conflicting expectations in human resource management systems and of the different levels of consideration given to the respect and practicality of humanitarian principles. As one interviewee noted: “Everybody wants something else!” (P8-14.25).

Constraining forces of work-related requirement

The *constraints* imposed by donors and Sudanese stakeholders are high. Donors have an obvious power in Sudan and use it freely. All leaders, without exception, confirm this fact through comments such as “we are dictated by their requirements” (P8-16.05), or “We must know very well what the donor wants”

(P3-38.40). This has an impact on the design of interventions, but also on the behaviours of leaders who must “adjust to their styles, their techniques and their personalities” (P5-36.23).

At national level, the imposition of the *constraints* enforced by Sudanese governmental bodies on humanitarian actions is confirmed by both operators and donors working in Sudan. Although the leaders perceived this control quite individually, in the end, it is the “government that decides if, where and how we work or ... not” (P4-10.10). The national frame clearly forbids any autonomy or free-will in interventions and also compels humanitarian leaders to display certain types of behaviours that have been compared by one interviewee to “role play” (P8-51.27).

In addition, the mandatory call for the ‘sudanization’ of humanitarian personnel obliges leaders to display leadership styles that prevent the development of innate dispositions or behaviours. Conscious that their staff is “spied on, controlled” (P3-44.40) or “culturally bound to ethnical rules and duty” (P7-27.37) leaders adjust their behaviour accordingly.

Consequence of constraints on results

The non-alignment to the strategy of leading donors will lead to a denial of grant, a fact has been asserted both by leaders and donors. Whilst funding is the sinews of war for humanitarian aid in general, the allocation of grants is particularly important in Sudan as it appears that the number of expatriate managers and technicians approved by the authorities is partly related to the size of the budget.

Leaders evaluate the monitoring system of their donors with a wary eye, stressing that what matters is to know how the evaluation will be done and act accordingly: “some donors only want to have nice reports and good numbers” (P1-23.18), while others will make acute and methodical monitoring visits. From this viewpoint, the influence of constraints on results varies, depending on the donor’s identity.

On the other hand, the constraints imposed by national bodies all seem to converge towards the ‘strong’ consequences pool. Leaders and donors illustrate through numerous examples that a lack of compliance with national requirements, no matter how volatile or restrictive they may be, has a direct impact on the sustainability of relief interventions. Since the turmoil of 2008-2009, the country seems to avoid the expulsion of organizations for political reasons. Yet, diverse overt and covert obstructive methods are used to block the operational procedures of humanitarian organizations until they finally volunteer to depart.

At Human Resources level, the consequences of the constraints on results are high. They force leaders to behave in specific ways without really knowing “what works or not” (P3-41.15) and have a direct impact on the results of humanitarian interventions. As one leader stated, “we do the best we can, without vision, without flexibility and without control” (P8 – 54.32).

Conclusion

In conclusion, despite initial evidence, the situational strength of the working context of humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan is generally strong, as summarized in the table below.

Table 7: Summary of findings on the situational strength of Sudan

REQUIREMENTS	LEVEL OF CLARITY		LEVEL OF CONSISTENCY		LEVEL OF CONSTRAINTS		LEVEL OF CONSEQUENCES	
	Are the work-related requirements clear?		Are the work-related requirements compatible?		Do these requirements restrict freedom of action and behaviour?		Are behaviours or actions influenced by effect on outcome?	
DONORS requirements	High			Low	High		high	Low
NATIONAL Requirements	High			Low	High		High	
HR situation requirements	High		High		High		High	

Source: adapted from (Meyer, et al., 2010)

Leaders know how framed and constraining their context is and adjust their actions and behaviours accordingly so as to provide their programmes with the maximum chances of success. Sudan is a hard and demanding place that is dealt with on a daily basis. The different mechanisms and behaviours used by the participants in their search for means of performance are presented in the next section.

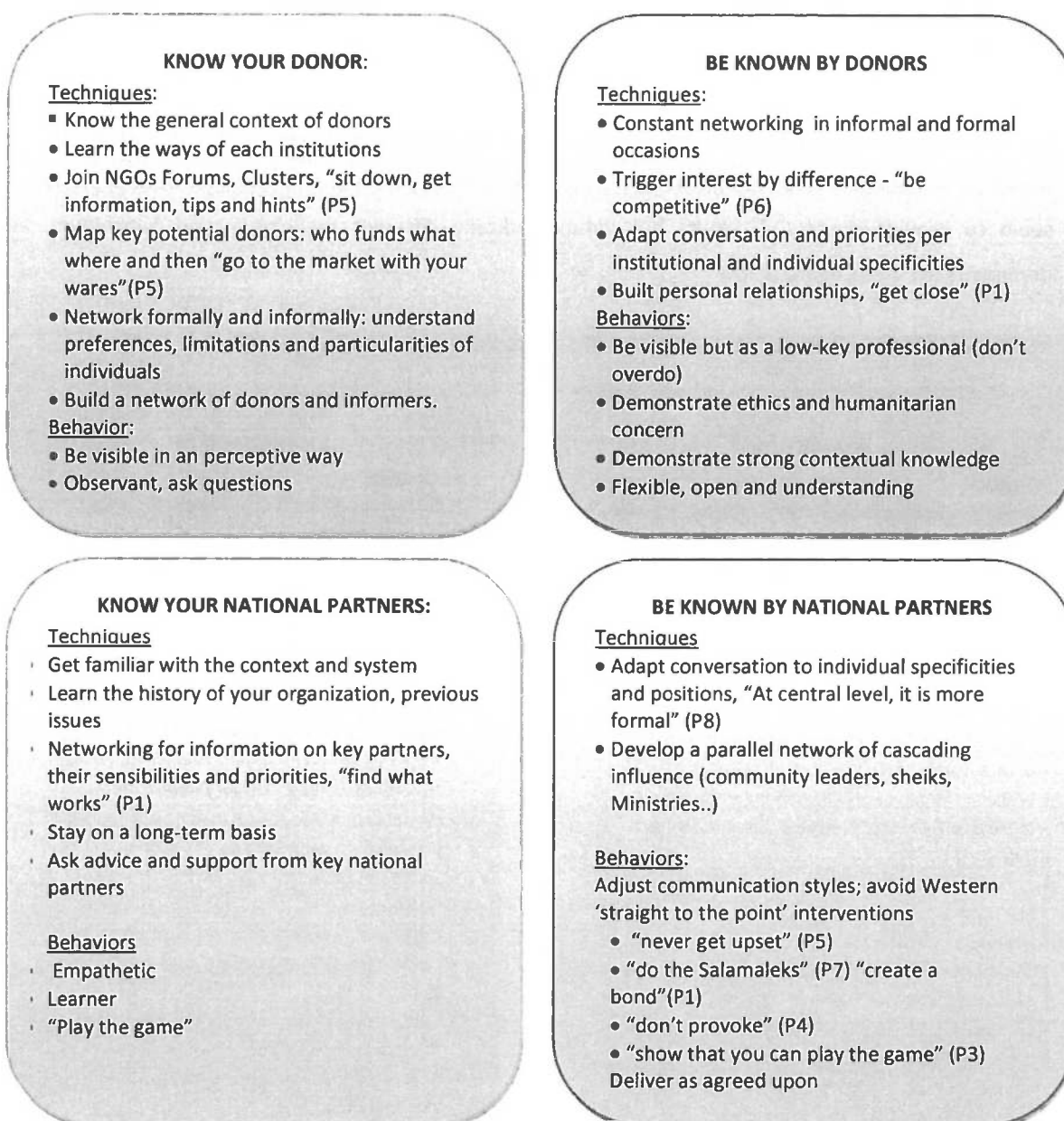
PHASE 2: Effective mechanisms and behaviours used by leaders in Sudan

It appears that, in such a pre-framed context, little room is left for creativity, innovation or uniqueness. Indeed, all but two of the participants create targeted responses that comply with the different existing requirements, attempting to progressively construct a multi-financed programme in which they can find some professional satisfaction. As stated by one interviewee, “in fact, it is like a puzzle, we take pieces from here and there, and redesign our frame of action” (P1-16.30). This approach could be likened, to some extent, to the Bricolage process.

Organizational ‘bricolage’ relates to the entrepreneurial ability to “do things with whatever is at hand” over time (Levi-Strauss, 1966, p. 17), by developing a familiarity with, and building on, the environment and its components (Duymedijan & Ruling, 2010). Developing a familiarity with the environment

appears to be of generic importance to leaders in Sudan who use different techniques and behaviours to gain knowledge of their context and of the particular characteristics of their stakeholders.

Figure 5: How to know and be known by key stakeholders in Sudan

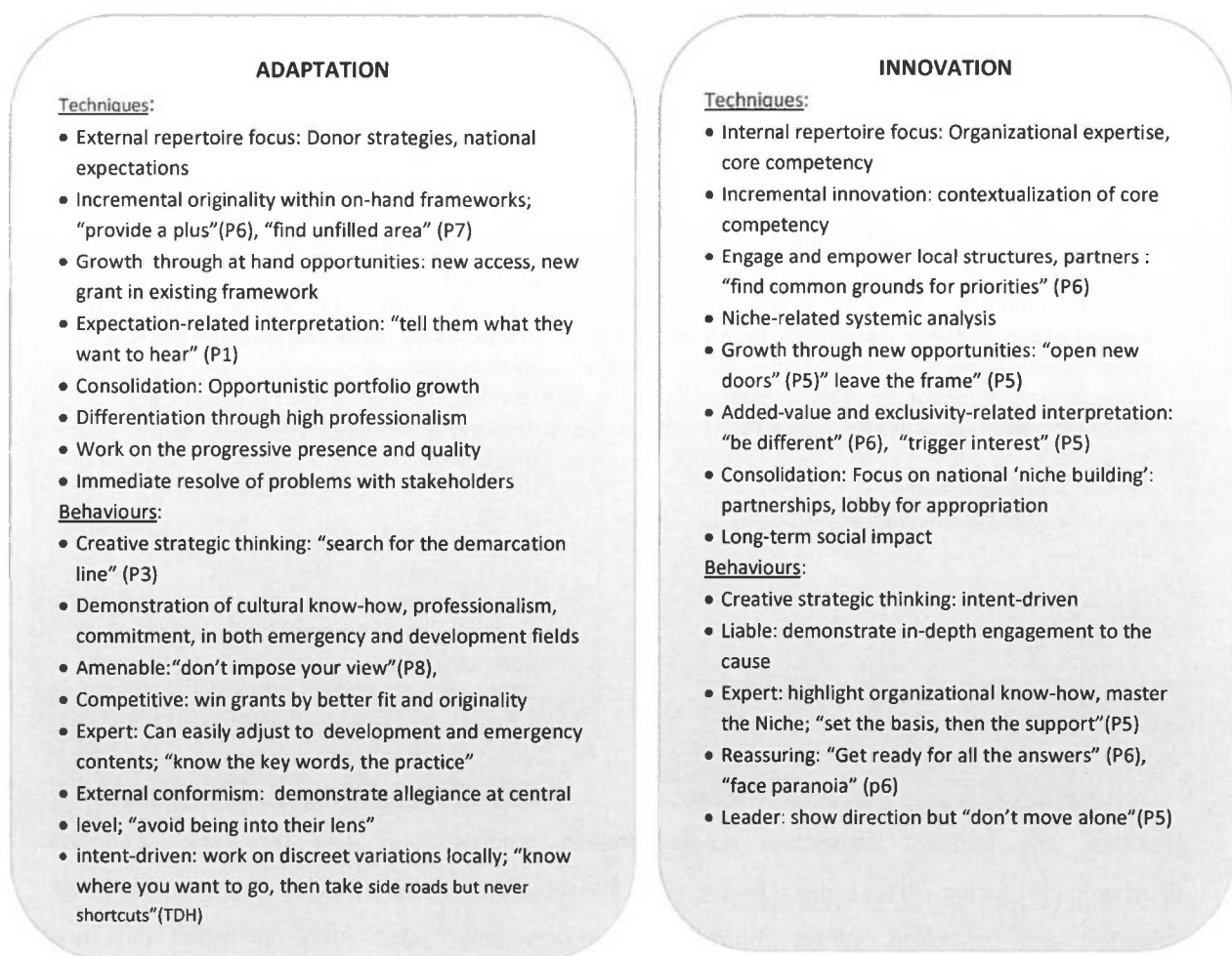


However, the frequent association made between ‘Improvisation’ and ‘Bricolage’ processes (Duymedijan & Ruling, 2010) is not relevant in the Sudanese context where every step is standardized, validated and controlled. Whilst context-based improvisation takes place in highly uncertain

environments (Baker, et al., 2003), the strong situational strength of Sudan prevents *intuitive or rapid* tactical moves (Duymedijan & Ruling, 2010). For similar reasons, the “real-time experience” (Miner, et al., 2001, p. 319) or “unforeseen results” (Leone, 2010, p. 11), characteristics of the Bricolage process, are unrealistic in the studied context.

Despite these reservations, there remain similarities with the Bricolage process. One lies in the fact that most participants build their programs on the basis of the environment and its components, interacting and shaping existing products and resources (Baker, et al., 2003; Duymedijan & Ruling, 2010). Others, however, will adopt a creative approach, planning for differentiation and innovation. Both approaches seem to provide successful results but induce radically different techniques and behaviours, as demonstrated in the figure below.

Figure 6: Comparative assessment of successful techniques and behaviours models

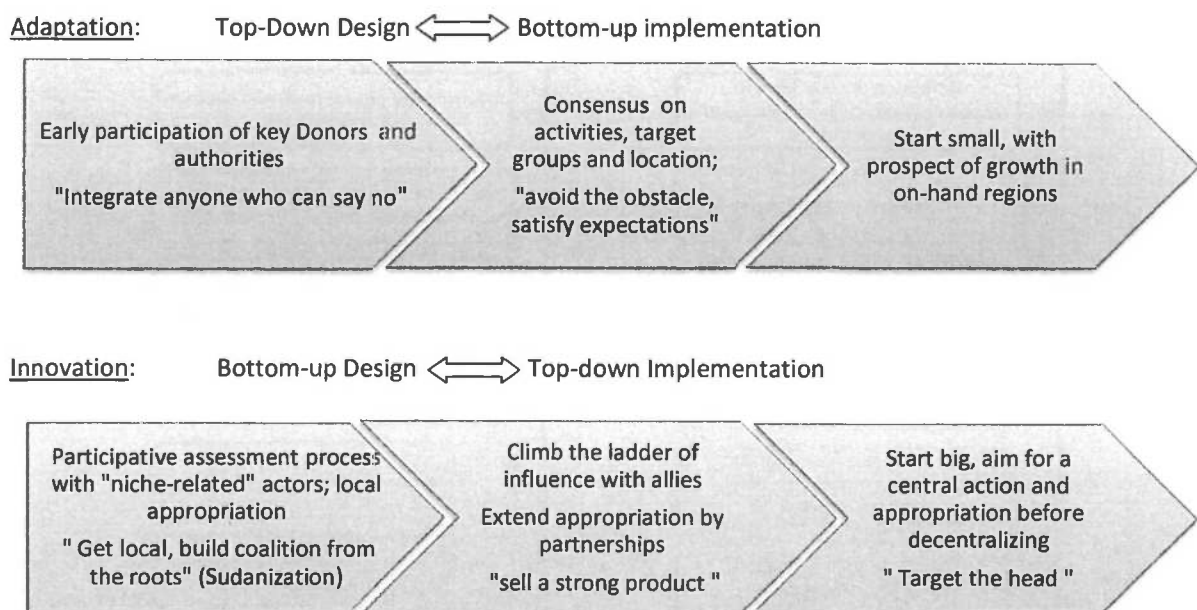


The innovation pattern brings specific benefits. The fact of introducing new perspectives in the aid response in Sudan is seen as a positive factor by the traditional development and emergency donors interviewed. Leaders state that they get a better response from "less rigid" (P5-37.10) bilateral donors in search of differentiation than multilateral donors². Also, the creation of a national coalition that supports and implements the program seems to ease negotiations at national level, reducing pressure and antagonism. In comparison to the rather derisive comments of some adaptive leaders, innovation-focused leaders appear less exasperated by national regulations and more confident in the final outcome of the programs.

However, this pattern presents prerequisites that are not easily obtained. First, it suggests that the organization has the field access and means to develop extensive participative research and ground-based analyses needed to target expertise at its best. Secondly, it requires that their headquarters agree to follow such a strategy which could entail less funding volume, less visibility and a "Sudanized" response implemented by national partners.

In addition to the need for different techniques and behaviours, these processes use different designs.

Figure 7: Comparison of design between adaptive and innovative processes

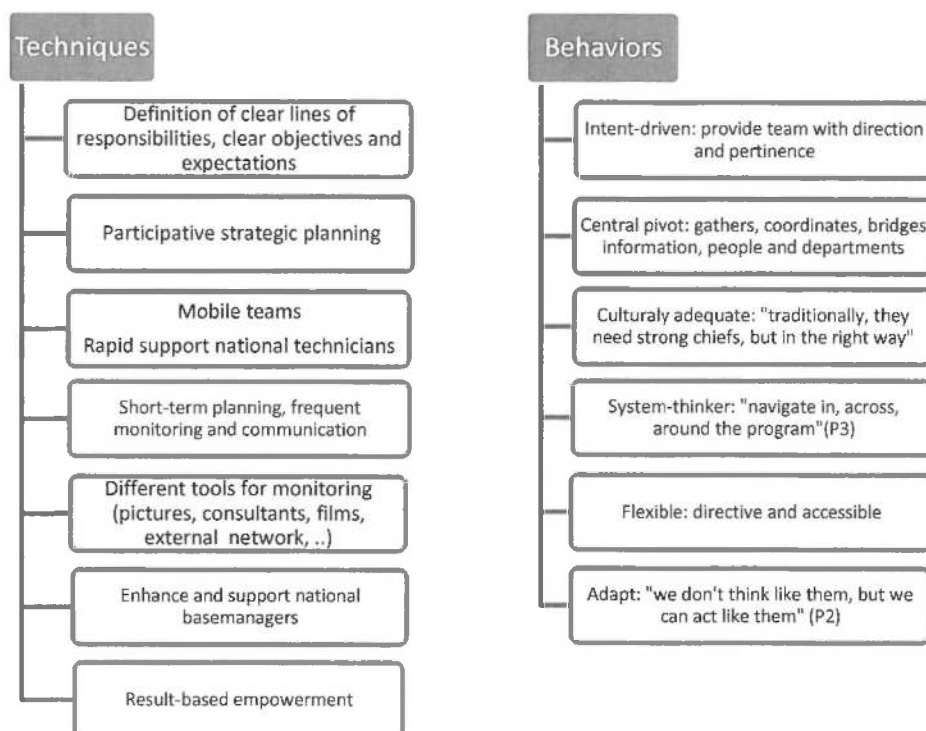


² Bilateral donors represent a donor government that directly provides aid to a recipient government or to an INGO operating in the recipient country; multilateral donors are the first recipient of donor countries' funds (UN, World Bank) who then administer and allocate the funds locally.

What differentiates these approaches is the ultimate goal of the program. Adaptive interventions target the consolidation of organizational presence and usually initiate decentralized actions at local level, progressively building regionally. Innovation, on the other hand, aims first for a central action. The design coalition is built from the roots to the head, reaching prominent notables of potent sectors who then get involved in its construct, support its implementation and federate the process before decentralizing it to provinces.

Whilst the innovation construct targets the appropriation of the program by host institutions with the support of expertise-related technicians from the organization, the adaptation process requires a larger pool of internal human resources as it covers a broader scope of areas and domains of interventions. In the adaptation framework, the restricted number of expatriates in the field and the limited skills of national members make the remote management system complicated. Overall, leaders have to compose with the “lack of rigor”(P3-39) as well as the lack of autonomy and objectivity of their local staff by using successful techniques and behaviours, as presented below. This figure uses selective quotations of interviewees where appropriate, to highlight the identified differences.

Figure 8: techniques and behaviours used under the “adaptation” pattern



Whilst the participants seem to have found their way to operate in Sudan, the rub lies in the elasticity of the ethics they reveal. The adaptation-focus participants argue that they “comply within certain limits” (GL) but that they do “compromise on certain principles” (P8-51.40) during negotiations with national authorities. In probing further, these participants inform that these principles are of a personal and institutional nature. Although all see this as necessary, their irritation and cynicism is palpable, leading to the assumption that they feel their authenticity is affected.

In addition, moral codes appear to weaken in the negotiations with donors, who are no fools and are markedly annoyed by the pretense of some humanitarian leaders in terms of their capacity, their access and results. Although this research provides no means of identifying whether any participant was centre-stage in the comments of donors, only one participating leader mentioned the importance of maintaining a transparent communication with donors. Considering that all adaptation-focus leaders stress the need to adjust their behaviours and their programs to the expectations of donors, questions can be raised on the long-term sustainability of those grants if unauthentic behaviours, forged capacities and fictitious access were detected.

In conclusion, in both adaptive and innovative patterns, effective leaders enact their environment and diversify their interventions, either through a responsive or innovative pattern. They adapt their behaviours and means according to institutional and individual expectations. Despite their importance, authenticity and ethics are constantly at stake in such a context. In the next Chapter, the skills and competencies required to display the above-mentioned behaviours and techniques will be presented and discussed.

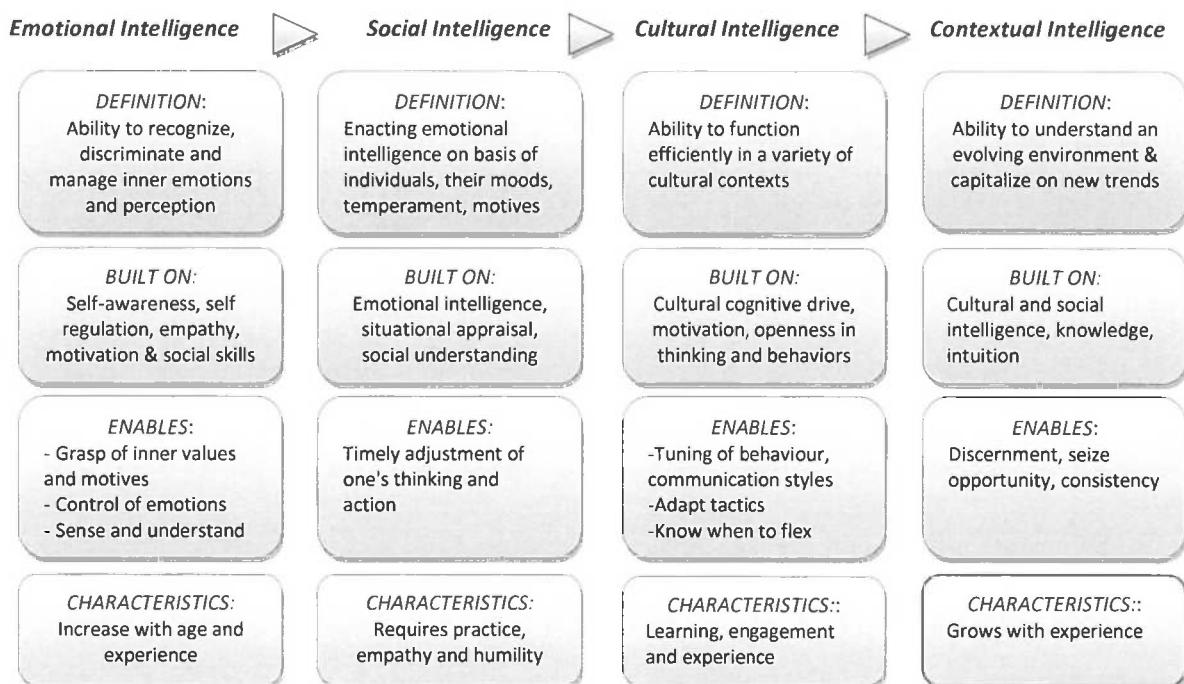
CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This Chapter reflects on the research findings and the broader lessons derived from the secondary research to develop a small number of key propositions on the nature of leadership function within the specific demands of working in humanitarian relief in Sudan.

The art of performing in the Sudanese humanitarian context lies in the ability to respond proactively to its multi-faceted constraints and requirements - without grievous loss of authenticity. This calls for a prior interpretation of the overt and covert components that build the environment (Nilsson, 2011). The numerous mechanisms and behaviours displayed by the participants to master their context or to know and be known by their stakeholders reveal the importance of adjusting thinking before taking action.

The way the environment is “registered, encoded, transformed, stored and retrieved” (Nilsson, 2011, p. 14) is an inner construct. Before envisaging reacting contextually to multi-faceted and constraining expectations, leaders in Sudan need to know who they are, how they function and what they stand for so as to regulate their emotions and respond to distinct social or cultural requirements in a perceptive manner. Therefore, emotional intelligence is the prime skill required to reach cultural and social adequacy, and indeed, contextual intelligence, as presented in figure 9.

Figure 9: Continuum of inner intelligence



Source: (Livermore, 2011; Ang, et al., 2011; Livermore, 2009; Goleman, 1998; Boal & Hooijberg, 2001; Gardner, 1985; Sternberg, 1985; Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004; Nye, 2008; Kutz, 2013) (Earley and Ang 2003)

All four components of this continuum are essential leadership skills for humanitarian leaders who need to develop flexibility in thought and to practically adjust to their distal and proximal contexts (Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004). As demonstrated in the above chart, each of these skills grows through experience, knowledge, practice and on-going learning along the assimilation-accommodation loop.

Proposition 1: To be effective in the Sudanese context, humanitarian leaders need a contextual intelligence built on strong interpersonal skills, cultural openness and experience.

However, the literature review shows that contextual intelligence is attained through particular individual characteristics that fit the context and mandate. What matters here is to define those that are essential to leadership in Sudan.

The participants demonstrate the will to learn and understand their context. Rather than being confined to specific opportunistic goals, they search and absorb information constantly, through reading, meetings or networking in formal and informal situations, looking for updates on security, political or humanitarian matters. A rich knowledge base is, for Perkins and Salomon (1989), a “direct determinant for performance” (p. 16) that enables leaders to optimize their strategic thinking and decision-making in unfamiliar or problematic situations. A high absorptive capacity to recognize and assimilate information will facilitate further accommodation “towards new ends” (Boal & Hooijberg, 2001, p. 517) and also “circumvent procedures” (ALNAP, et al., 2011, p. 50).

Proposition 2: Leaders determined to learn their distal and proximal contexts are better prepared to face hazards and seize opportunities.

The coping contextual adjustment mechanisms used by leaders in Sudan demonstrate two core enacted skills: a flexibility in tactics and their creativity in responding to limitations and constraints. Flexibility is a skill that is expressed by highly experienced and skilled leaders (Nilsson, 2011, p. 50) who can face different situational types of challenges simultaneously and have learned to carry competing roles and behaviours in an integrated manner. Such flexibility is expressed in their ability to know “what to do, how to do it and when to do it” (Yukl & Lepsinger, 2004, p. 236). Yet, in the Sudanese context, this flexibility tends to approach an ethical borderline, somehow tainted by a diplomatic ambiguity.

The participants keep conventional activities related to humanitarian diplomacy, such as promoting human rights or advocating respect of international laws (Regnier, 2011), at a distance. As shown in the situational strength analysis, the 'consequences' related to the diverse requirements are, at high level, considerable. This induces a cautious and decentralized diplomatic diligence. These diplomatic efforts are incessant and transversally required in multidimensional negotiations, demanding flexible behaviours and techniques. The diplomatic skills displayed by participants are exclusively related to organizational benefits as they aim to differentiate their organization from others. For donors, who talk to each other frequently, such diplomatic applications can appear deceitful when humanitarian leaders compare, criticise or denigrate other organizations, or when they lack consistency in their multiple argumentations. Attempting diplomatic negotiations demands prior abilities.

Diplomatic abilities find their roots in the interpersonal skills developed through emotional, social and cultural intelligence, so as to tactfully lead counterparts to common grounds and agreements, in a trustworthy manner (Regnier, 2011). It is a crafted intent-focus process that presupposes extremely good communication abilities such as body-language awareness, communication tactics, consistency and self-control (Skillsyouneed, 2012). In this specific context, behavioural flexibility must also be grounded in personal ethics, honesty and consistency.

Proposition 3: Experienced humanitarian leaders with strong interpersonal and adaptive skills are more likely to display a trustworthy diplomatic behaviour.

Creativity is the second skill that enables leaders to perform. By seizing opportunities through differentiation or by radically shifting between intervention-based approaches, leaders can make a difference that donors appreciate and that triggers the curiosity of national stakeholders. Indeed, despite their framed strategies, donors do search for impact and distinction and assert their openness to pioneering interventions as long as they enter their frame of references. Against all odds, creative strategic thinking is therefore a valuable asset for humanitarian leaders in Sudan.

Creative thinking is about expanding the boundaries of reflection by challenging personal mental models, by enlarging the scope of comprehension through associated views on realities and opportunities so as to develop a new contextual appreciation, therefore conception (De Wit & Meyer, 2010; Gavetti, 2011). Creative thinking is, however, only relevant if it integrates the strategic purpose of the organization, suggesting that it is intent-driven and is supported by facts so as to determine its

desirability and feasibility (Bradley, et al., 2012). The creative proposition must be contextualized and purposeful.

The importance of strategic purpose cannot be stressed enough. The tendency to diversify interventions so as to maintain a sufficient financial mattress has, for donors, a questionable impact on the credibility and the stability of organizations. The on-going assimilation and accommodation processes should not impede the pursuit of a strong strategic direction. Intent-driven skills relate to the ability to articulate, communicate and maintain a sense of purpose that is conveyed internally and externally (Kings, 2010). Undeniably, when considering the use of bricolage techniques in Sudan, it is essential to develop an internal stability and an external cohesion through a clear mandate over time (Maira & Scott-Morgan, 1997).

Proposition 4: humanitarian leaders operating in Sudan need strategic thinking abilities to generate an effective differentiation through a consistent and coherent creativity on a long-term basis.

Another technique used by adaptive leaders is to assert their expertise in both development and emergency domains, so as to gain funding from both sides of these distinctive administrative systems. Besides the fact that simulating a systemic ability is seen negatively by donors, the need to combine relief and development aid is unavoidable in protracted crisis, and such dual abilities should be considered indispensable (Harmer & Macrae, 2004). Yet, the secondary literature is noticeably silent on the leadership skills required to manage and integrate both development and emergency interventions. These call for radically different knowledge and expertise, sometimes even suggesting contradicting methods and skills (Kopinak, 2013). Sudan, in its protracted characteristics, requires leaders who master both concepts of aid, so as to bring strength and consistency to the patchwork of diverse and constraining opportunities that they face.

Proposition 5: Effective leaders in Sudan master both emergency relief and development aid configurations.

One factor triggered the researcher's attention throughout the data analysis. A different degree of derision and contempt is clearly marked between adaptive and innovative leaders. Although all express their annoyance related to the government control and restrictions imposed over their operations, stronger personal satisfaction and fulfilment is felt in leaders who have led pioneering interventions. As one of these leaders said, they will "play the game, but under (their) own terms". These leaders develop

programs in which they clearly believe. This preserves their ethics and integrity, despite behavioural accommodations. The direction is set and compromises are made within boundaries defined by the expertise and values of the organization.

In addition, these leaders develop progressive national coalitions and partnerships that ease negotiations and communication activities. They seek to alleviate the risk of losing their self-esteem or principles. More importantly, they thereby protect their authenticity, essential to purpose-centred context transcendence and to genuine consideration (Bennis, 2009; Puente, et al., 2007).

Proposition 6: Effective leaders in Sudan preserve their authenticity by developing a context-bound innovative responsiveness to the humanitarian needs of Sudan.

Finally, innovative patterns also facilitate the management of Human Resources considering that interventions are expertise-driven and are implemented through national partners. This reduces the pool of national staff and limits the need for expatriates to specific experts and senior managers.

Conversely, adaptive leaders constantly face challenges imposed by the human resources situation in Sudan. Whilst the remote-management system decentralizes operational decision-making to the field, the precarious quality of the context, the cultural standards and the constant setbacks force leaders to remain in control. They are accountable and responsive. They provide the direction, coordinate the motions and develop proximity through mechanisms such as mobile teams or direct and frequent monitoring systems. These leaders remain 'visibly' in charge (Hannah, et al., 2009), thereby neutralizing the negative effects of leading at a distance.

To display the required -and traditionally expected- authority despite this distance, leaders need charisma (Hannah, et al., 2009). Charisma is a demonstration of competence, confidence and intent (Yukl, 2009), that demands self-efficacy formed from learning and experience (Wood & Bandura, 1989). In close leadership relationships, charisma stimulates the follower's identification through behavioural models. In distant leadership relationships, however, charisma is a matter of inherent authority built on expertise, performance and inspiration as perceived and attributed by teams rather than individuals, creating a sense of belonging and cohesiveness (Yagil, 1998; Antonakis & Atwater, 2002).

Therefore, leadership charisma in Sudan refers to the ability to convey professionalism and intent to teams through typical transformational attributes such as idealized influence (Bass, 2008), and also

through specific traits such as assertiveness and decisiveness, defining, from a distance, clear team goals and unambiguous direction in order to enhance the cohesion and performance of teams.

Proposition 7: Effective leaders in Sudan are assertive team-leaders who demonstrate high proficiency and purpose.

In conclusion, *contextual intelligence* is the essential skill required to lead effective humanitarian interventions in Sudan as it enable leaders to understand, align and respond to different situations and complex environments in a creative manner (Kutz, 2013; Nye, 2008). It entails that *experience* and *interpersonal facilities* are the first leadership traits required for this context as they develop two cultural intelligence components, knowledge and cognitive capabilities.

Sudan requires leaders who are proficient in dynamic tensions management. In this context, tension management relates to the art of balancing differing and often contradictory perspectives, demanding different styles, behaviours or skills. It also includes the ability to maintain the balance between the needed leadership demonstrations and one's inner values or characteristics. Whilst this equilibrium requires *adaptability* in style and *flexibility* in thought, it must be rooted in a central purpose so as to avoid strategic, operational or individual drifts (De Wit & Meyer, 2010). By enacting their environment, leaders maintain control over their strategy and their personal boundaries, emphasizing "choice over compliance" (De Wit & Meyer, 2010, p. 443). Therefore, effective leaders in Sudan have *strong strategic thinking abilities* and acute *self-management* skills, balancing facts, experience and ideas with visionary opportunism, whilst keeping personal boundaries and the end in mind (Heracleos, 1998; Raimond, 1996).

Effective leaders in Sudan exist and make a difference. Yet, it would be a mistake to confuse effective leaders with effective leadership, which relies on more than the capabilities of a single person. Further research is needed to evaluate how stakeholders can best accompany these leaders in their adaptive or innovative quest. Fields of reflection are suggested below.

RECOMMENDATIONS

At organizational level, it is worth evaluating how leaders are identified, supported and motivated in existing recruitment, training and evaluation formats. Most organizations tend to replicate internal systems or tools despite the distinctive contexts and requirements of their various programs. This can undermine the selection, development and engagement of leaders. Contextualization is a concept that should be well integrated at headquarters level before reaching the field.

Also, the managerial procedures between the organization and its leaders-in-country are worth re-considering. As the identification of the 'next-best-move' is likely to come from the country leader's intimate relation with the environment, modifications in the decision-making tree of some organizations might be needed in order to provide leaders with organizational support rather than additional limitations. A demand-driven response provided by headquarters could, in such cases, be particularly relevant.

Expecting leaders to be flexible and creative entails that the organization, as a whole, functions under an open and supportive framework that promotes these behaviors and skills (Yukl, 2009). This will require an adjustment of organizational culture, which demands time and managerial drive. The creation of a specific HQ support unit that designs targeted procedures and provides specific support to leaders would ease this cultural shift, progressively developing the organizational proficiency within the new humanitarian environment.

Finally, on a more general term, the question is whether and how donors and organizations are prepared to face a reality that challenges their principles, their values and their mandate. Whilst the debate on the elasticity of humanitarian principles is important in the redefinition of the humanitarian sector (Leader, 2000), today, organizations and donors should also examine their motivations and aptness to operate within this new framework.

REFLECTION ON THE DISSERTATION PROCESS

This research was undertaken for personal reasons related to my concern when observing how humanitarian interventions were led in Sudan. Why do some leaders manage to reach their goals and others don't? Where does the difference lie, truly? Who are these successful leaders? I wanted practical answers that could be of use to leaders.

Whilst my profession essentially concentrates on solving problems and finding answers, this specific project has radically changed the way I usually operate. Rather than a fast-paced, experienced-based reflection, I learned how to probe, analyze, connect and defy information and ideas in a multifaceted and objective perspective. I enjoyed the search, the questioning and association of views, progressively building a web of interconnected information and knowledge. I learned to resist first-hand conclusions, asking myself "are you sure about that?", something I rarely did before. My engrossment in this process enabled me to avoid personal assumptions and to question data and theories through double-loop learning. This unprejudiced connective thinking ability is a skill that I shall nurture as it will impact the relevancy of future decision-making and my performance in general.

However, this is my first dissertation attempt and my first research project. Although it was an exciting and challenging mental journey, my lack of practice as an interviewer turned that process more into a crusade. Untrained and unaware of the different social profiles and styles of interviewees, I lacked the versatility to identify and adjust to their behavioural clues. No matter how well prepared I thought I was, each interviewing session had its specific expectations, rhythm and relation well set by the interviewee. Managing the rapid adjustment to individual characteristics while concentrating, listening and probing, as well as discarding any form of personal interference, turned out to be quite a strenuous process. Clearly, any further research will require more practice in adapting my social skills to such situations.

Overall, this research project has widened my knowledge of the humanitarian sector considerably. Initially targeting the 'unique situation of Sudan', the appreciation of the scope of change in the humanitarian field gathered from the literature review, altered the breadth and the construct of this research. Inductive study demands a flexibility that I first discarded in an attempt to maintain the dissertation proposal in focus. Loss of time and frustration could have been easily avoided with a better prepared mind. Today, at the end of this project, I take with me not only the practical learning of a research process, but also a whole new working environment that I will, from now on, address differently.

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ANNEXES

ANNEX 1: Proactive Influence Tactics

Rational Persuasion	The agent uses logical arguments and factual evidence to show that a request or proposal is feasible and relevant for important task objectives
Inspirational Appeals	The agent appeals to the target's values and ideals or seeks to arouse the target person's emotions to gain commitment for a request or proposal.
Consultation	The agent asks the target person to suggest improvements or help plan a proposed activity or change for which the target person's support is desired.
Exchange	The agent offers something the target person wants, or offers to reciprocate at a later time, if the target will do what the agent requests.
Collaboration	The agent offers to provide assistance or necessary resources if the target will carry out a request or approve a proposed change.
Apprising	The agent explains how carrying out a request or supporting a proposal will benefit the target personally or help to advance the target's career.
Ingratiation	The agent uses praise and flattery before or during an attempt to influence the target person to carry out a request or support a proposal.
Personal Appeals	The agent asks the target to carry out a request or support a proposal out of friendship, or asks for a personal favor before saying what it is.
Legitimizing Tactics	The agent seeks to establish the legitimacy of a request or to verify that he/she has the authority to make it.
Pressure	The agent uses demands, threats, frequent checking, or persistent reminders to influence the target to do something.
Coalition Tactics	The agent enlists the aid of others, or uses the support of others, as a way to influence the target to do something.

Source: (Yukl, 2007, p. 111)

ANNEX 2: Humanitarian Principles

PRINCIPLES	THEORY	PRACTICE
HUMANITY	The imperative of saving and protecting lives, alleviating suffering wherever it is found	Analyze the political effects of aid on access, protection and compromises
NEUTRALITY	Aid should not favour any side in a conflict nor engage in controversies of a political, racial, religious or ideological nature	Develop acute politically-aware (rather than politically-driven) surveillance to preserve integrity
IMPARTIALITY	Humanitarian action should be carried solely on the basis of need, making no distinction on the basis of race, nationality, gender, religions, beliefs or class or political opinions	Negotiate access to aid for all populations of the selected areas
INDEPENDENCE	Humanitarian action must be autonomous from political, security, economic or other objectives	Balance the politicization of aid with intrinsic principles-> how far can we go?

Source: Collinson and Elhawary (2012), Macrae (2001), Leader (2000)

ANNEX 3: Situational Strength Data Compilation

AREA		Clarity: are work-related requirements clear?		Consistency: Are work-related requirement consistent?		Constraints: Are work-related requirement constraining?		Consequences on results?	
		HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW
National Authorities	P1	Upon GVT to decide where to work or not.	Confusion on what they actually want: ex of IDP in camps, no clear move or action, on the contrary	No consistency between stakeholders; the local guy for HAC is from the area, he does care much about what KH wants, more formalized at federal level ; difference at local levels, must adjust to guy	na	Must negotiate for access, of no, compromise on next best area You are constantly on the border line in terms of personal ethics and principles. (53.27)	na	No clear visibility, so no real idea, thus replication, without understanding new needs -> quality? Temporal adjustment to state and donor expectations, a sort of limbo state, no one knows what is going on, the donor or us.	na
	P2	Country searches to have control on humanitarian intervention "each step in controlled, nothing can be done without authorization"	na	na	More interactions with ministries at local level and with HAC in KH. A certain disconnect with HAC and security. Support at local level, but not at national level. Can induce tensions and change in TA	Takes a lot of time All actions can be suspended or cancel if the NIS analyzes them as a threat to their security No access to emerging crisis	na	Compromise on principles when acceptable. Draw lines but can work with national NGO who is close to the GVT, "we accept that because no other alternative". Complicate to work with all populations, as no authorizations. So accept to work with more locals, in identified zones in hope to progressively spread No ability to react promptly to crisis	na
	P3	Clear governmental behavior demanding organizational compliance Detailed Technical Agreement on operations ratified by GVT Detailed regulations on national expectations, procedures, access to areas, to staff String control system, M&E by GVT staff	na	At GVT level: coherence on pressure placed by levels of GVT coordination bodies	At integrated level: no coherence with other stakeholder expectations on behavior (ORG/DONOR/Staff)	Threats of blockage if non-compliance to regulations / threat of staff pool reduction if too limited funding/ Presence in SD validation on basis on M&E by GVT bodies / very limited expats on field / no access of CD in 3 out of 4 areas / extensive time, finances and effort for a simple agreement; " THE biggest problem, called HAC who is controlling and hampering most of our efforts"	na	High: Wrong decision implies expulsion from areas or from country "(...) takes a lot of energy to relate with them, discuss with them, having them approve each single sheet of paper"	na

National Authorities	P1	Clear individual expectations, especially in institutional, not UN, where it is a real mess	na	Different types of donors, all for different mandates, need to shift from one to the other; No consistency with national strategy, conflict of agenda (ER/EM), some zones are stated ER but in fact are EM, thus donors don't fund them	na	Constant pressure for compliance to regulations; no freedom of action, of strategic approaches;	na	Impact on programs, need to combine short term and long term in same areas, thus difficult, more work to make bridge in terms of HR and finance constantly, hard to get long-term results	na
	P2	Protracted brought new rules and control ; Obligation to work with national INGOs Objective to reduce the international presence to nihil in 2016;	Procedural frame existing but not really respected by national authorities who hold it ;	na	CONTEXTUAL CRISIS: everything is morcelled, it is a patchwork of many sub-groups, different types of populations No real coherence on the long-term Impossibility to build vision in this country	Weekly confrontation to obstacles Lots of constraining rules and regulation that all go one way, against organizations who are compelled to follow them, but the others parties are not respecting them	na	Very high (assez terrible) consequence if no compliance to regulation frame: expulsion, non-grata, threats, ..	na
	P6	Frame through T.A. that sets the rules and expectations - not much space to act	na	Na: at Gvt level: only refers to central level for the moment	Donors not aligned to national desiderata	Advised by HAC to keep a "low-profile" due to two previous expulsion of 2 CDs.	na	Follows directions from HAC, goes to places that are accepted, new introduction to Blue Nile following recent access; "there are needs everywhere, anyway"	na
	P7	Completely framed, at all levels	Difference in national parties management at central and local levels: more flexibility at community based level	na	No consistency with donors and organizational strategies, feels "ecartele" under the different expectations	No compliance = numerous risk and a lot of pressure, security risks, lack of support from donors too, who know if we are in the "red" vision of national authorities	na	Must fit in, brings problems in terms of access, people dying and no access. Frustrating for staff and for organization	na
	P8	High in regulation, control, limitations defined behaviors: compliance	Competing bodies with different expectations Little knowledge of Arabic culture by leaders	High in general restrictions	Low at cascading level	High: no freedom of behavior: compliance and diplomacy	na	High: no compromise, no compliance, no agreement	na

DONORS		Clarity: are work-related requirements clear?		Consistency: Are work-related requirement consistent?		Are work-related requirement constraining?		Consequences on results?		
		HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH		LOW
	P1	1. Individually yes you must know very well what the donor wants, what they want to support, 2. Short term funding, max one year for emergency, lack of funding, so early recovery not included	na	Country needs increasing of funds but funding probably going down -> focus on specific mandate	Lack of coherence (ex schools in camps): donors with the head in the sand	Some donors have high regulations and contractual constraints - strong monitoring of quality of operations Adaptability to each donor format in terms of reporting, monitoring, has an impact on the level of attention, quality put in the interventions.	Some donor only want to have nice reports and numbers	No possibility to work on longer term issues should be able to address the issues better No good vision of what is going on, thus same type of strategies Constantly adapt priorities to get funding Pool of expats depending on funding		na
	P2	Adapt to donors' expectations, dictated by their requirements Respond and compose to the guideline of donor: look where we want to be and do, see who funds what, and we adjust Some donors are completely inflexible, such as emergency donor More constraining nf focus because less funds in general	ECHO insist on expat presence but it also keen on security issues -> complex	Shift of strategy and approach as per new arrival of director (ECHO) -> must adapt too No, very clear lines of demarcation between them and no consensus "on fait le grand ecart constamment" 45.00 - UN funding are complicated: constant changes, short term funding, reduction of grants in on-going project, etc	na	Short term funding of some donors, reduces the frame of action, the vision In one area, we will adjust our proposal under the emergency or development scheme, and present it respectively	na	No freedom to go where we want, do what we want as very small proper funds Avoid approaching donors who are too complicated No possibility to react rapidly, as all agreements needed No flexibility in actions/ interventions in zone of no interest of donors Short term funding reduces performance of activities		na
	P3	Conformism with donors' strategy on themes and areas of support	Decentralized UN funding system, leading to confusion on grant allocation and agreement Extensive delays in securing grants "It takes one year to have an agreement on a grant with OFDE"	na	No inconsistencies within donors' own criteria (UN), internal tension at donor levels, loss of time, unclear process, unclear expectations and strategies	Extensive work and time needed to balance the funding proposals from local to central levels,; " 6 months from agencies in the field and in the capital, trying to get a signature, constantly adapting our views"	na	Must comply to donor's desiderata and delays or no funding		na

DONORS	P4	Clear expectations, know what to provide and how to do it	na	Less funds thus donors tend to refocus and limit their frame of actions, more strict, more limitative	Hard to manage all expectations, better to choose for one relief method, but not possible due to National limitations	Limits the frame of action, sort of tight up to external (frm org) mandate	na	No compliance = reduction of future funding, bad "press" amongst donors who know each other	na
	P5	High clarity in terms of institutional and individual requirements at donor level	Less funds due to lack of trust in Gvt - trust - crisis for no respect of donors' engagement	Within one donor yes,	No long term vision of donors All external stakeholders are complied to follow national strategic direction but only INGOs do it -> Hard to combine both donors and Gvt rules	Hard to combine both: national and donor to have funds and access - Always move from one to the other, no way to sustain any program, they don't want it to work	na	If no compliance, no future funding Less expats if less funding NGOs must comply to donors so many revise their position and play on terms to re-develop emergency to get funding. -> lack of focus, of coherence and thus performance	
	P6	Clear expectations, like it, know where we go and how it works	na	Only two donors, not much inconsistency	na	Constraining only if no real focus in terms of area or mandate	na	Poor results will cancel future funding Less funding entails less expats	na
	P7	Existing strategies and proposals templates from each donors, "they actually tell you what to right"	na	na	No common vision or strategy, actually no strategy at all on long term	Must fit the tables as expected, more flexibility once the proposal is accepted, if the core lines of actions are respected	na	Donors have full power on NGOS, thus lots of hypocrites around, people talk more than they work.	na
	P8	Clear expectations from donors, own objectives	na	Clear demarcation between emergency and development donors	No common strategy even in one domain of action, different expectations, rules, procedures	Limitations in actions and hard to fulfill mandate of organization	na	Less performance because no means to maintain a focus on a long term No compliance = no future funding	na

		Clarity: are work-related requirements clear?		Consistency: Are work-related requirement consistent?		Are work-related requirement constraining?		Consequences on results?	
		HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW	HIGH	LOW
HR	P1	Mandatory to have direct management on field -> expats on each base	na	Poor resources nationally, 6 month to find a HR officer Not well educated, lower level then needed, lot of coaching required, or directive, it depends	Not very loyal to organization, fast turnover, big HR war for the good Sudanese staff	Need to sustain Expat: motivation? Getting pressure from HAC on total of expats	Less constraints due to expats presence	I am pretty sure that the quality we have now is because we have expats on the field; I am not so sure we would get the same results with local	na
	P2	No expat on the field - National strengthening for sudanization -> limited amount of staff 2. organizational decision to avoid ay fix expat on the field for security	No easy to manage local as we are not there; hard to evaluate the needs of the staff, to respond to it. Hard to detect what works and why, or not.	na	Different level of competencies, autonomy, rigor	Use of relocated for less influence. 2. lower competencies, less rigor	na	Local management, punctual control 2. question raised on quality, due to no direct leadership 3. risk of bias analysis due to distance	na
	P3	No expats on the field - clear Sudanization: regulation on number of expats + actual pressure: no fund, no expats "they want us to recruit locally"	na	na	Fast turnover, HR war amongst organizations	Work with unprofessional staff Local GVT control o the staff: "the staff is actually controlled, spied on"	Local GVT control o the staff: "the staff is actually controlled, spied on"	Remote leadership with little monitoring for security and HAC reasons Recruitment of impats" all the decision on the field are of Impats" Limited funding (ECHO)	HR monitoring not included in program evaluation
	P4	Limited educational background, little abilities to take decisions, to sell a project, to manage finances.	Difference as long-stand staff who know and are engage, vs others who don't really commit , just there for the money	Supervision needed as there is an expectation for "direction"	some good staff, motivated and trust, but always a risk due to local pressure and cultural rules	Must show we are there, even at a distance. Constant monitoring needed to have the expected results, presence must be felt	na	Less performance comparing to other countries	na
	P5	Lack in education thus no relevant staff, also influenced by the culture of esclavagism, no one takes decision here, big boss does, and you comply, very strong socio-cultural effects, that impact on decision-making and initiatives.	na	The socio-cultural system helps the fact that message are heard, must be behind, because needs someone to make thing run. Must be behind, next, ahead, ..	na	Must design everything, prepare all, check if done, why not, be behind people, etc, make the machine move forward. Thus needs expats, so real complicated as no expats here	na	Must not expect too much if no one is there to monitor	na

HR	P6	No expats, thus strong need for local supervision from central level! little engagement, little passion	na	Overall a need for direction, monitoring	na	Reduce the organizational capabilities, don't expect too much, start small, try to train and coach	na	Less effective results, but there are ways if you target their bounds to either culture, villages, etc, but than risk of favoritism.	na
	P7	Very limited capabilities on field, demands different management system versus other countries	Limited openness from staff thus difficult to know here they stand, how they grow	They are all under pressure locally, so we must be conscious about internal affairs.	Must probe to feel who needs what, but they all cover each other	Requires remote management and relocated staff to have a proper functioning base.	na	Definitely poorer and longer results, little possibility to develop appropriate management and support, frustration	na
	P8	Constant problems with HR, in terms of recruiting, maintaining, training. Even with good training abroad, little improvement	They do not only work for organization, lots of external pressures and expectations, cultural bounds, so hard to define a relation of trust or stability	People all work for the money, not for the mandate, so more easy to motivate if good staff	Different in capital or field	Things move when goes on the field, presence appreciated by staff but hard to visit all bases frequently Must remain careful about external pressures, need to keep a hand on decision and financial spending.	na	Time and patience needed, but not always possible string risk of bias in work as external pressure	na

ANNEX 4: Behaviours and Mechanisms Data Compilation

	Participants		P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
	TOPICS		MECHANISMS - NATIONAL							
Knowledge	know national stakeholders	✓	✓	✓	"Before some meeting I brace myself"	✓	✓ "know each of them as they are all different"	✓	✓ "It is funny, in the end, we are like actors"	✓ "role play"
	Contextual knowledge	✓ "we scan. Always, everything, everywhere"	✓ "I spend 40% of my time in meetings, forums, I need to know"		✓ "the thing is, we must know all what is happening, but never write about it"	✓	✓ "know the reality of our partners, how far they can go"	✓	✓ "things are always on the move, so I must know what is going on"	
	Contextual experience	✓ (more than 2 years presence)	✓ "I have been here XX years, so, well, I know the music"		✓ "must stay on a long term-basis"	✓			✓	
	Mapping of key contacts	✓ "Identify key stakeholder per issue"	✓ "know your key partners"	✓	✓	✓ "screening, casting of relevant actors at all levels"	✓	✓ "some people here makes things move"	✓ "In the end, it is about people; who is in charge, who can put pressure"	
	Find what works	✓ Know individual characteristics	✓	✓ "things change, the reality change, so there are always openings"	✓	✓ "built key partnership of influence"	✓ "there is always a way if you have something special to provide"	✓ "it is simple. Some can work, others can't. the question is why"	✓	
Compliance	Compliance to desiderata	✓	✓ "work in designated areas with designated populations with no animate "	✓	✓ It is the gov that decides if, where and how we work, or not"	✓ "don't move alone"	✓ "Even in our programme, we have to stick to the regulations"	✓ "respect "a la lettre" of "procedural frame"	✓ "they are the bosses"	
	Negotiations	✓ "find what works" "find common interest at local level"	✓ "negotiate on areas"	✓ "we keep adjusting, all the time"	✓	✓ "Search for the monde ligne de resistance "	✓ "We work with universities, they really want to engage"		✓ "you would not believe how many hours we spend on discussions, pleading, negotiating"	
	Compromises	✓ "accept the nearby spot"	✓ accept local INGOs despite political influence	✓	✓ "ethics must prevail on operationality"	✓ "go around obstacles, find what really we can bring. In or out the frame"	✓ We don't really compromise, we find common grounds"		✓ "I do compromise on certain principles"	
	Ethics	✓ "border line between what is right and what is approved"	✓ "ethical inflexibility on certain principles"	✓ "denied when ethics is touched"	✓ "be aware of ethical issues, otherwise we get lost"	✓ "satisfy expectations but maintain ethical line in line with own expertise and org principles"	✓ "it is about who we are, what we are, and find the bridge"			
	Participative process	✓ "Integrate everyone who can say no"	✓ + "Integration of local communities"	✓ "good relationship with communities"		✓	✓ "we don't build our programme, we build their project"	✓	✓ integration of local NGOs	
	Participative end and beginning	✓ "that is the only way, it must become theirs"	✓	✓ "Find ways together"		✓		✓		
Operation	Competitiveness	✓ "find places no one goes to or activities no one does"				✓ innovation in produit, in process, in sudanization and in selling	✓ be different, target added-value	✓ "it is like a treasure hunt, the first one there gets the gold"		
	Know what is going on	✓	✓ Mobile teams	✓ mobile teams		✓ "manage on a contextual basis"		✓ Mobile teams	✓ "everyday communication"	
	Deliver the service	✓	✓ "as agreed upon"		✓		✓ "provide a plus"		✓ "they come and ask why you did not do such and such, even if they know the answer"	
	Work on future improvement	✓	✓	✓ "once we are there, we can grow"	✓ "we then work locally, bit by bit"		✓ "then the programme gets decentralized at regional level"		✓ "we grow on the spot"	
Communication	build formal and informal contact	✓	✓	✓	NA: "I don't want to get into their games"	✓ Communicate new elements, trigger interest	✓		✓ "at central level, it is more formal"	
	Immediate dealing with problems	✓ "avoid being into the loop"	✓		✓	✓		✓ "when we are in trouble, we learned it from other NGOs. Then, it is nearly too late"	✓	

Participants		P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
TOPICS		BEHAVIOURS - NATIONAL							
Communication	Networking	✓ inter-NGOs networking for information	✓ Listener, in all forums and working groups	✓	✓		✓		✓ forums, meetings, working groups
	Low profile	✓	✓	✓ "They don't like 'visible' people"	✓	✓ Get known through local actors, not directly	✓	✓ "Big mouth have a short term success here"	✓
	Culture-based communication	✓ "make a checklist of forbidden words"	✓ "adjuits, do the salamalek"	✓ "show that you can play the game"	✓ "avoid Western-like rational thinking and communication, find what suits them"	✓ "never get upset"	✓ common sense, if you want people in, you must behave as expected	✓	✓ "Full control on our emotions, of our attitude"
	Adjust ot cultural expectations	✓ "create a bond" "present things in a certain way"	✓ "create dialogue and trust"	✓		✓ Work on their own system, build idea internally	✓	✓ "do the salamaleks"	
	Avoid terms or attitude	✓ "present things a certain way"	✓ "culturally accepted"	✓ "avoid conrontations" "bow the head"	✓ "don't provoke"	✓ "soft communication, soft infiltration"	✓ "I react the same, but don't act the same way"	✓ "for example, words like protection create reaction, you attract their attention"	✓
	Empathetic	✓ Visible empathy (demonstrate concern)	✓ Listen a lot - empathetic	✓	✓	✓ "manage on a contextual basis"	✓ "We adapt our expertise to their standards, their needs"		✓ "Don't impose your view"
Behavior	Flexible and malleable	✓ "don't get stubborn on fix ideas"	✓ "don't insist, work on future positioning"	✓		✓ Flexibility for little things, keep people happy	✓	✓ adjust behavior on the mood of counterparts.	✓ "I know how to be"
	Maintain direction and ethics	✓ "know how far you can go"	✓ "compliance within limits"	✓ "there is a point where I can not go any further"	✓ "ethics prevail"	✓ "Maintan ethical line"	✓		✓
	General compliance	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	✓

Participants		P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
TOPICS		MECHANISMS - DONORS							
Knowledge	Know (institutional&individual)	✓ pre-discussions	✓ "and avoid tricky ones"	✓ Know their specificities		✓ "sit down, get information, hints and tips"	✓	✓ "I have worked with all of them before, I know how they function"	
	Mapping who funds what how	✓ "see who funds what"	✓	✓	✓	✓ "go to the market with your wares"		✓	
	Know what is expected	✓	✓ "some donors are completely unflexible"	✓ "must know very well what the donor wants"	✓ 'Find the entry point'	✓ "each have their individuality, know them and adapt"	✓ "they all search for something new"		✓ "everybody wants something else"
	Emergency vs development	✓	✓ "and present different project respectively"	✓	✓ "we cover both, it is not easy"	✓ (12 years in development, 8 years in emergency)		✓ "adapt the project to their key-words, to their indicators"	
Operations	Bricolage	✓ "in fact, it is like a puzzle, we take pieces from here and there"	✓	✓	✓ "we adjust all the time"				
	Strategic adaptation	✓	✓ maintain organization in unclear waters then adapt to each donor	✓	✓			✓ "i revised it three time last year"	✓ "we are dictated by their requirements"
Operations	Tactical adjustment	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓ "adjust to their styles, their technics, their reputations"			✓
	Adjust vs monitoring system	✓ "Some only want nice reports"	✓	✓ "Most donors are not allowed to"	✓ Strict organizational			✓ "It is a big one-day show"	✓ difference between donors noted
	Multi-levelled funding system	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	
	Competitiveness / innovation	✓ option analysis for differentiation: who does what where				✓ "open new doors" "breaks through doors no one has tried before"	✓ "find your niche that suits them"	✓ find unfilled areas	
	Be different zone, product	✓ "we try to go where there are few NGOs"		✓ "Search for the demarcation line"		✓ be different in terms of areas and products	✓ "be competitive in content and form"	✓	✓ "must sell a difference, somehow"
Communication	Compliance	✓ "tell them what they want to hear"	✓ "we completely adapt to their expectations"	✓ "bring in all their key words"	✓	✓			✓ "It is a question of how we present things"
	Specific communication approach	✓ "get close"	✓	✓ "tell them what they want to hear"		✓ "each donor has his style"	✓ "Get ready for all the questions"	✓	✓
	Transparence		✓						
	controlled communication	✓ story: meeting two donors with different agendas		✓ "timely information"	✓ "be aware of what to say when"			✓ "the smallest thing can become huge by the second"	✓
	Communicator: transparency		✓ whatever happens, I let them know, before rumors start"	X timely information	X timely information: what to say when	X timely information			
	Visibility	✓ "get close", show experience	✓ "meet them, formally and informally"	✓	✓			✓ "They are meetings where they expect us to be, so I go"	
	Built relationship with donor	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓

DONORS	Participants	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
	TOPICS	BEHAVIOURS - DONORS							
	Networking, be there	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	✓ in meetings where donors go
	Low-key professional	✓ "they fund people and NGOs they trust"	✓ "build the trust", "work on the future"	✓		✓ "trigger interest, be know for good reasons"		✓ "prepare for meetings, now what you will say"	✓
	Entrepreneurial	✓ analyze the market, lobby for intervention", avoid risk-avoidance behaviors				✓ Think differently, trigger interest, be competitive	✓		
	Demonstrate ethics	✓ depending on donor	✓	✓ "draw the lines at some point"	✓ "We can sometimes question the quality of our intervention"	✓ important to donors; "maintain neutrality"	✓ "not difficult if you are sure of what to do"		
	Constantly aware, ready	✓ "screening for next funding"	✓ "there is a real competition for funds, for local staff, for areas"		✓			✓ learn from the mistakes of other NGOs	✓ Short funding, never-ending fun research
	Adaptable, flexible behavior	✓	✓ "we do the grand ecart constantly"	✓ Change behavior, discourse ref donor		✓ within limits, don't buy anything		✓ adapt to donor	✓ Adapt to donor and to new constraints
	Manipulator	✓ "go with the flow, say what they want to hear"	✓	✓ "not too much honesty, find the way"	✓ "Must prove there is still need, that it is an emergency, it works"	✓ Not play, but model to avoid crise		✓ "targeting the right sector with the right words"	

DONORS	Participants	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
	TOPICS	BEHAVIOURS - DONORS							
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	Low-key professional	✓ "they fund people and NGOs they trust"	✓ "build the trust", "work on the future"	✓		✓ "trigger interest, be know for good reasons"		✓ "prepare for meetings, now what you will say"	✓
	Entrepreneurial	✓ analyze the market, lobby for intervention", avoid risk-avoidance behaviors				✓ Think differently, trigger interest, be competitive	✓		
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	Manipulator	✓ "go with the flow, say what they want to hear"	✓	✓ "not too much honesty, find the way"	✓ "Must prove there is still need, that it is an emergency, it works"	✓ Not play, but model to avoid crise		✓ "targeting the right sector with the right words"	

HUMAN RESOURCES	Participants	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
	TOPICS	BEHAVIOURS - HR							
	Delegate with control	☒	☒ "We can less delegate in this context"	☒ "constantly navigate in, across and around the programme"	☒ "different lines of responsibilities"	☒ "need to know what is going on, show you are there"	☒	☒ "fishing for information on how things go"	
	Be accessible	☒ Open office, constant in and out, available		☒	☒	☒	☒ "... even for little things like days off"		☒
	Adapt style	☒	☒ coaching, mentoring, directing, ..	☒ depend on people, on the emergency	☒	☒	☒	☒ it depends on the people, it is a result-based thing"	☒ Alternate different styles in line with people
	Directive style	☒ "... end up telling what to do"	☒ balance empathy and directive	☒ "at a point, I give orders, because then things move"	☒ "have to be quite clear about what I want"	☒ "I tried to wait but they never come with solutions" (local staff)		☒ "you need a strict control on everything here"	☒ "we do the best we can, without vision, without flexibility and without control"
	Controller		☒ "it requires a high level of supervision, accompanying, supporting"	☒	☒ "to get a real feedback from the field is not smth INGO are very successful at here, so we must be alert"	☒ "must be behind, before, next to people"		☒ Monday AM meeting on field progress	☒ "low level of autonomy, of rigor"
	Be the coordinator, bridge people	☒ Decision-making pillar	☒ "be the intermediary"	☒ "Connect people"	☒	☒ link internal and external; central focus point	☒		☒
	Culturally aware	☒ "traditionally, they need strong chiefs"	☒	☒	☒ "it is better to have face-to-face discussion, more respect come out of it"	☒			
	Authenticity		☒	No: "we must draw a line on who we are"			☒		